

HOMES TO GET ROOFTOP SOLAR WITH UP TO RS 1.75L SUBSIDY **P3**



CSE 2025: SC TO HEAR CENTRE'S PLEA ON OBC CREAMY-LAYER RULE **P5**

GAL ADDRESSES 'WONDER WOMAN' EXIT **P14**



GOVT SAYS YOUTH WELFARE UTMOST PRIORITY

SC quashes all FIRs against NEET protesters, CJP calls off Sept 5 march

AIMAN FATIMA
New Delhi, September 1

The Supreme Court on Tuesday ordered the closure of FIRs registered across India against students who took part in protests linked to the NEET paper leak between July 20 and 25, saying the cases should not stand in the way of their future prospects. The ruling also recorded the Centre's commitment to formulate a nationwide policy for compensating families of NEET-UG aspirants who died by suicide following the examination crisis, with the compensation to be provided within three months.

The order prompted the Cockroach Janta Party (CJP), which had led the student protests, to withdraw its planned September 5 march in Delhi. CJP co-convenor Saurav Das made the announcement before a bench headed by Chief Justice of India Surya Kant and comprising Justices Joymalya Bagchi and V Mohana.

KEY POINTS

- » Relief covers protests held July 20-25 nationwide
- » Similar FIRs elsewhere will also be treated closed
- » No fresh FIRs allowed over those protest incidents

SC invoked Article 142 for complete justice

- » Order considered young protesters' future prospects
- » Delhi Police can pursue one specific FIR
- » That FIR involves 2,873 Jantar Mantar participants
- » Those individuals allegedly have serious criminal antecedents

The court said FIRs relating to the protests during the July 20 to 25 period should not be pursued or investigated and would be treated as closed. It also said that if similar cases had been registered in any state or Union Territory but were not before

the court, they too would not be pursued. The bench invoked its powers under Article 142 of the Constitution, which allows the Supreme Court to pass orders necessary to do complete justice. The court said the decision was taken considering

the future prospects of the young protesters and was subject to the understanding reached between the parties being honoured. Solicitor General Tushar Mehta told the court that the Centre, along with Maharashtra, Assam, Bihar and West Bengal,

had sought the quashing of FIRs connected with the agitation. The relief was subsequently extended to similar cases across the country. There was, however, an exception. The court allowed Delhi Police to proceed with a case involving 2,873 people who were present at the Jantar Mantar protest and were found to have serious criminal antecedents. The Centre also told the court that it would formulate a nationwide compensation policy for families who lost their children after the NEET examination controversy. The process and modalities are to be worked out within three months, with the government providing compensation to the affected families. Union Health Minister J P Nadda welcomed the ruling and said the government had already assured protesting students on July 25 that cases against them would be withdrawn and that no **CONTINUED ON P4**

MPOST BUREAU
Bishkek, September 1

Prime Minister Narendra Modi on Tuesday urged the Shanghai Cooperation Organisation (SCO) to confront countries using terrorism as an instrument of state policy and reject "double standards" in the collective fight against terror financing and recruitment. In the presence of Pakistan Prime Minister Shehbaz Sharif, Chinese President Xi Jinping and many other global leaders, PM Modi said that "we cannot remain confined to an action-reaction approach" in the fight against terrorism as terrorist activities continued to pose a serious challenge to humanity. His remarks are being widely seen as a direct swipe at Pakistan. Calling for decisive action within the SCO, the Prime Minister advocated for the comprehensive dismantling of terrorist ecosystems, including funding networks, recruit-



Prime Minister Narendra Modi with Russian President Vladimir Putin and Chinese President Xi Jinping during the SCO Summit, in Bishkek, Kyrgyzstan PTI

CLOSER LOOK

- » India highlights 13 outcomes from SCO summit
- » Modi's SCO vision rests on security, connectivity, opportunity
- » Modi calls for dismantling terrorist funding networks

- » PM seeks action against terrorist recruitment pipelines
- » Modi calls for dismantling terrorists' territorial sanctuaries
- » Terrorism can never become anyone's strategic asset
- » Modi's remarks appeared directed at Pakistan

ment pipelines, and territorial sanctuaries. He further affirmed that states utilising terrorism

as a policy tool must be warned that terrorism can never be a "strategic asset for anyone." **CONTINUED ON P4**

Briefs

ATF price, commercial LPG rate up

NEW DELHI: Aviation turbine fuel (ATF) prices were raised by 5.46 per cent on Tuesday, adding Rs 6.28 per litre to the cost of jet fuel for domestic airlines. The new rate stands at Rs 121.28 per litre, according to state-owned oil companies. The increase follows a Rs 5 per litre hike on August 1. With ATF accounting for as much as 40 per cent of airline operating costs, the latest rise will add to carriers' expenses. Commercial LPG also became costlier, with the price of a 19-kg cylinder rising from Rs 2,738 to Rs 2,747.50. The 5-kg market-priced LPG cylinder, known as 5-kg FTL, saw its price increase from Rs 762 to Rs 764. The latest LPG revision comes after two monthly cuts. Rates were reduced by Rs 183.50 per cylinder on July 1 and by Rs 192 on August 1. **CONTINUED ON P4**

NCLT stays Chandra's repayment plan

NEW DELHI: The NCLT on Tuesday stayed approval of Essel Group Chairman Subhash Chandra's repayment plan, citing no clear majority, against claims of Rs 22,006 crore for a Rs 6.5-crore recovery. A five-member bench barred him from alienating assets. Dissenting lenders challenged the plan at NCLAT. The NCLT will hear the matter September 23. **SEE P11**

Gross GST mop-up rises 14.8% in August

MPOST BUREAU
New Delhi, September 1

Gross Goods and Services Tax (GST) collections rose 14.8 per cent year-on-year to Rs 1,99,853 crore in August, supported by higher domestic transactions and imports. Revenue from domestic transactions increased 9.3 per cent to more than Rs 1.37 lakh crore, while collections from imports jumped 29 per cent to Rs 62,604 crore. Gross Central GST stood at Rs 38,413 crore, State GST at Rs 46,316 crore and Integrated GST at over Rs 1.15 lakh crore. Refunds during the month rose 68 per cent to Rs 31,795 crore. After refunds, net GST revenue stood at Rs 1.68 lakh crore, marking an 8.3 per



cent increase from a year earlier. The August figures came a day after official data showed India's GDP grew 7.8 per cent in the June quarter of FY27. The GST numbers indicate continued activity and consumption in the second quarter, despite tariff-related pressures and the West Asia crisis. Between April and August, gross GST collections rose 11 per cent year-on-year to Rs 10.43 lakh crore. The GST Council is scheduled to meet next on September 12, when taxation-related matters are expected to be discussed.

Centre halves sugar stock limit for dealers

MPOST BUREAU
New Delhi, September 1

The Centre has cut the stock holding limit for sugar dealers by half to 2,000 quintals, seeking to curb hoarding and speculative trading amid a sharp rise in retail prices. The revised limit will apply from September 15 to November 30. The earlier ceiling of 4,000 quintals, introduced on August 1, will continue in Kolkata and its extended metropolitan areas due to the region's specific market requirements, the food ministry said on Tuesday. Under the amended rules, dealers cannot keep sugar for more than 30 days from the date of receipt. They will also be barred from holding more than **CONTINUED ON P4**

NEARLY 4,000 STILL MISSING Nepal: Death toll crosses 1,000 as rescuers recover more bodies

MPOST BUREAU
Kathmandu, September 1

The death toll from the flash floods that devastated parts of Nepal rose to 1,050 on Tuesday as security forces recovered more bodies from eight districts, officials said. Rescue operations continued amid intermittent rain and fresh flood warnings, with rising water levels in several rivers making it difficult to reach stranded people. The National Disaster Risk Reduction and Management Authority (NDRMA) said nearly 12,000 people had been rescued, while around 4,000 remained missing. The missing include 583 foreigners and 83 security personnel. The floods struck north-



APF personnel carry the body of a flash flood victim to a mass burial pit at Ram Ghat near the Narayani river, in Devghat, Chitwan, Nepal, on Tuesday PTI

ern and central Nepal on August 26 after ice and rock collapsed or an avalanche occurred near the Nepal-Tibet border. The resulting waters surged

into the Bhotekoshi River and swept downstream, destroying homes, vehicles, roads and bridges and damaging hydropower projects. **CONTINUED ON P4**

SC seeks Centre's view on use of totalisers for votes counting in EVMs

MPOST BUREAU
New Delhi, September 1

The Supreme Court on Tuesday sought the Centre's response on petitions seeking the introduction of totalisers for counting votes recorded in electronic voting machines (EVMs), saying it wanted to know what could prevent the use of the system. A bench headed by Chief Justice of India Surya Kant and comprising Justices Joymalya Bagchi and V Mohana asked the Union government to examine the issue and inform the court about any impediments to introducing totalisers. A totaliser is a device that enables votes from around 14 polling booths to be counted **CONTINUED ON P4**

Over 7,200 corruption cases probed by CBI pending trials

409 for more than 2 decades

ASHWINI SHRIVASTAVA/PTI
New Delhi, September 1

Over 7,200 corruption cases probed by the CBI were pending trials in different courts, including 409 for more than two decades, according to a latest report by the Central Vigilance Commission. Out of the total of 7,229 cases pending trials in courts, 1,612 were pending for less than three years, 860 for over three years and up to five years, and 1,901 for more than five years and up to 10 years as on December 31, 2025, the Central Vigilance Commission (CVC) report said. As many as 2,447 cases registered under the Prevention of Corruption Act were pending for more than 10 years and up to 20 years, and 409 for over 20 years, the CVC annual report 2025 said. There were around 14,083 appeals and revisions, including writ petitions, pending in high courts and the Supreme Court. **CONTINUED ON P4**

MICROSOFT, ORACLE, META, AMAZON AND OTHERS SLASH WORKFORCE

Tech layoffs cross 175,000 in 2026 as AI reshapes jobs, hiring and workforce plans

MPOST BUREAU
New Delhi, September 1

More than 175,000 technology workers have lost their jobs globally in 2026 so far, putting the industry on course for another year of large-scale workforce reductions as companies restructure operations, cut costs and shift spending towards artificial intelligence and other newer technologies. The pace is already faster than in 2025, when more than 245,000 tech workers were laid off during the full year. In India, the changing approach is visible through Microsoft placing hundreds of employees on performance improvement plans, Oracle preparing another round of job cuts, and tech-

CLOSER LOOK

- » AI remains a major driver of workforce restructuring
- » Microsoft placed around 500 India employees on PIPs
- » Oracle may cut 2,000-3,000 jobs in India

TCS added 9,000 employees, its biggest increase in years

JOBS DISPLACED | HIRING SLOWDOWN | WORKFORCE PLANS REVISED

- » India's top five IT firms cut 6,981 jobs
- » They had added 12,718 employees during FY25
- » IT workforce grew by only 1.35 lakh in 2026
- » Six major IT firms added 5,400 employees in Q1

nology companies becoming more selective about freshers and campus hiring. Microsoft has put around 500 employees in India on performance improvement plans, according to estimates from Pareekh Jain,

chief executive of market research firm EII RTrend. Jain said about 2 per cent of Microsoft India's workforce, or roughly 400 to 500 employees, could be covered by the company's global PIP exercise.

The move does not necessarily mean those employees will be dismissed. Microsoft said it uses formal performance improvement plans and global voluntary separation processes as part of its workforce **CONTINUED ON P4**

Journalist challenges police request for digital data in SC

MPOST BUREAU
New Delhi, September 1

Journalist Abhishek Upadhyay has approached the Supreme Court challenging a Ghaziabad Police request to X, formerly Twitter, seeking his digital activity records from June 1, 2026. Upadhyay's lawyer, Advocate Anoop Prakash Awasthi, told a bench headed by Chief Justice of India Surya Kant and Justices Joymalya Bagchi and V Mohana that X's California headquarters informed the journalist on August 26 about the request from the Criminal Investigation Department of Ghaziabad Police. Awasthi argued that the data sought has no connection with the road rage case registered against Upadhyay on August 18. He said the period covered by the request coincided with the journalist's work on reports about alleged theft of Ram Temple donations in Ayodhya. "Digital footprints being sought from June 1, 2026 up till date," Awasthi said, adding that disclosure could reveal **CONTINUED ON P4**

BUS GANG-RAPE CASE

Cops map route using CCTV and phone data

OUR CORRESPONDENT

New Delhi, September 1

Delhi Police are mapping the route of the sleeper bus in which a 16-year-old girl was allegedly gang-raped earlier this month, using CCTV footage and the mobile phone location of one of the accused, with investigators also finding that the vehicle was issued eight challans in Uttar Pradesh in July, mostly for speeding, officials said.

One of the challans, issued in Hamirpur on July 23, was for Rs 23,000 for allegedly operating the bus without a permit, while five of the eight challans were issued in Mathura. The total value of the challans was Rs 54,000, police said.

The bus was purchased in April and registered in Firozabad on April 28, according to the investigation.

Police are using CCTV footage collected from several locations, including Kashmere Gate, Timarpur parking and Pari Chowk in Greater Noida, to reconstruct the movement of the bus on the night of August 4.

One of the cameras captured the bus getting onto the Hanuman Mandir fly-over, which investigators believe will help establish its route.

The footage is being analysed alongside the location data of the accused's



CLOSER LOOK

- » The bus was purchased in April and registered in Firozabad on Apr 28, according to the investigation
- » Police are using CCTV footage collected from several locations, including Kashmere Gate, Timarpur parking and Pari Chowk, to reconstruct movement of bus on night of Aug 4
- » One camera captured bus getting onto Hanuman Mandir fly-over, which investigators believe will help establish its route
- » It has been found that no verification of the accused was done by the bus company, according to police sources

mobile phone to map the bus's movements and identify the places where it may have stopped during the journey, a senior police officer said.

The victim's clothes, which allegedly bear blood and semen stains, have been sent to the Forensic Science Laboratory and will be matched with the DNA samples of the two accused, bus driver Kuldeep (39) and conductor Sandeep (26), both residents of Kanpur.

It has been found that

no verification of the accused was done by the bus company, according to police sources.

The victim's clothes, the seat cover and CCTV footage are expected to form important pieces of evidence in the case, police said.

The 16-year-old girl, who had left her home in Mainpuri after being scolded by her mother, boarded the bus at Pari Chowk in Greater Noida on a rainy night, believing the conductor's assurance

that it would take her to Noida Sector 63, where her cousin lived.

The bus, however, was not on regular passenger service that night. It had been taken to a workshop in Surajpur, Greater Noida, for repairs after developing a technical fault and was subsequently being taken towards Kashmere Gate for painting, according to the travel company that operated it.

Police allege that the two accused picked up the girl around 9 pm and proceeded towards Kashmere Gate. During the journey, they allegedly raped her inside the moving bus and threatened to kill her when she resisted.

The girl was abandoned near Kashmere Gate and later reached the police station in an auto-rickshaw, where she reported the incident. Delhi Police registered an FIR and got her medically examined, which confirmed rape, officials said.

With the help of CCTV footage, police traced the bus within a few hours and arrested Kuldeep and Sandeep from a parking lot in Timarpur. The bus was seized and the accused underwent potency tests, police said.

Forensic teams found the girl's hair inside the bus as police examined CCTV and technical evidence. The DCW sought an action-taken report.

Delhi govt: Bus operators warned of penalties over safety violations

OUR CORRESPONDENT

New Delhi, September 1

The Delhi government has directed all bus operators, including those from other states, to strictly comply with passenger safety and operational norms, with violations inviting action under law.

Transport Minister Dr Pankaj Kumar Singh said, "Passenger safety is non-negotiable," stressing that safety systems must remain functional.

Operators have been directed to ensure working Vehicle Location Tracking Devices (VLTs), panic buttons, fire extinguishers and first-aid kits. Buses must be parked only at authorised, secure and adequately lit locations.

Curtains and unauthorised window films are prohibited. Drivers must possess valid licences, uniforms and PSV badges, while conductors must have valid licences and badges. Staff verification is mandatory, and driving under the influence of alcohol or intoxicants is prohibited.

Crews must behave courteously and assist persons with disabilities. In cases of harassment or other offences against women, crews must immediately inform police and take the bus to the nearest police facility. Buses must meet fitness, PUC, emission and traffic norms. Violations could invite penalties, impounding or permit cancellation.

A city of horns and highways: New model maps Delhi's noise

PRESS TRUST OF INDIA

New Delhi, September 1

In Delhi, where a traffic signal can mean a chorus of horns, busy roads run alongside homes and hospitals, and elevated Metro tracks cut through densely built neighbourhoods, noise is an almost constant feature of urban life.

A new study conducted under the Council of Scientific and Industrial Research (CSIR) has now developed a model that combines geographical and real-time traffic data to map environmental noise across the city.

The study seeks to address the limitations of conventional noise-monitoring methods by integrating land-use and geographical factors with real-time traffic variables such as vehicle counts, speeds and honking. The approach could provide a more accurate and cost-effective way of predicting and mapping noise across a complex urban landscape such as Delhi.

Titled "Integrated land use regression (ILUR) model with road traffic characteristics for environmental noise prediction and mapping in urban regions with heterogeneous traffic conditions", the study uses Delhi as a case study to develop a framework that could help authorities understand the spatial and temporal distribution of noise and plan more targeted measures to control it.

The significance of the research lies in the nature



TO CAPTURE THE CITY'S COMPLEXITY, RESEARCHERS USED NOISE OBSERVATIONS FROM 201 LOCATIONS ACROSS DELHI

of Delhi itself. Unlike cities where residential, commercial and industrial areas are more clearly separated, the capital has a highly mixed urban landscape.

As the study points out, residential colonies often sit alongside markets and commercial establishments, while schools and hospitals can be located close to busy roads. Different types of vehicles share the same roads, traffic conditions change through the day and honking is a prominent part of the city's traffic environment.

These characteristics make Delhi particularly difficult to study through conventional noise-monitoring methods.

To capture this complexity, researchers used noise observations from 201 locations across Delhi. The study also incorporated data on hourly traffic counts, vehicle speeds and honking events, along with information on roads, land use, population density, built-up areas, metro infrastructure, railway stations, bus stops and traffic

crossings. The monitoring exercise was carried out over nine months, from October 2023 to June 2024, allowing the researchers to account for seasonal variations in noise.

The study found that hourly traffic count was the most influential predictor of environmental noise across all four models developed. The number of honking events was also among the most influential predictors, particularly for daytime, 24-hour and day-night noise levels.

For a city such as Delhi, where road traffic is widespread and honking is frequently observed, the finding offers a more realistic picture of how noise is generated and distributed.

Researchers developed high-resolution noise maps for New Delhi, showing strong links between noise levels, roads, land use and urban infrastructure. Study found varying acoustic patterns across areas and said traffic management, honking enforcement and noise-sensitive planning could help address Delhi's diverse noise pollution.

IRS daughter's case: Court frames rape, murder, robbery charges

OUR CORRESPONDENT

New Delhi, September 1

A Delhi court has framed charges of rape, murder and robbery against a former domestic help accused of killing the 22-year-old daughter of a senior Indian Revenue Service (IRS) officer at her south Delhi residence, paving the way for the trial to begin this month.

Additional Sessions Judge Ankit Singla framed the charges against accused Rahul Meena and fixed September 7 for commencement of prosecution evidence. A detailed order is awaited. According to the prosecution, Meena, who had earlier worked as a domestic help for the victim's family, allegedly entered their Kailash Hills residence on April 22 using a hidden key when her parents were away.

He allegedly assaulted and raped the woman before strangling her and fleeing with cash, jewellery and mobile phones.

The 22-year-old, an engineering graduate and UPSC aspirant, was found unconscious by her parents after they returned home. She was taken to a hospital where she was declared dead.

Police have alleged that the accused strangled her with a mobile phone charging cable after sexually assaulting her.

Meena was arrested from a Dwarka hotel after the incident. Police filed a 493-page chargesheet alleging rape, murder and robbery, while investigators examined CCTV, gait patterns and his movements.

Roommate beaten to death after drinking session in Najafgarh

New Delhi, September 1

A 46-year-old man was arrested for allegedly beating his roommate to death in Najafgarh over a trivial issue after they both consumed alcohol together, police said on Tuesday.

The incident occurred around midnight on August 28 at a rented accommodation in the Ajay Park area in Najafgarh, where the victim, Dadan (46), a resident of Amethi in Uttar Pradesh, lived with the accused, Ranjit Ram, the police said.

According to the police, both had consumed alcohol together, and later got into an altercation

over some issue.

"Around midnight, Ranjit allegedly assaulted Dadan with fists and blows to his face and head. During the assault, Dadan fell on the floor and sustained an injury," a senior police officer said, adding that blood was also noticed at the spot.

Ranjit allegedly found Dadan dead the next morning and informed his family. The incident came to light on August 29 after Dadan's nephew Ramesh made a PCR call. Police inspected the scene, sent the body for postmortem and registered an FIR. MP05T

New Delhi, September 1

A video showing police personnel and a Delhi Transport Corporation (DTC) driver consuming liquor inside a Police Control Room (PCR) vehicle has gone viral on social media, prompting departmental action against those involved.

The video, which surfaced on social media platforms, shows staff consuming liquor while inside the PCR vehicle. The footage quickly went viral, with several social media users demanding strict action against the personnel and questioning the conduct of the staff while on duty.

Alcohol inside PCR vehicle: Head constable suspended

"Taking cognizance of the viral video, an enquiry into the alleged incident has already been conducted. The erring staff, including a Delhi Police Head Constable and a DTC driver, have been identified. The Head Constable has been placed under suspension, while the DTC driver has been attached to the Lines.

Further departmental action for misconduct is being initiated by DTC," Deputy Commissioner of Police (PCR) in a post on X said.

The post further read that Delhi Police does not endorse or tolerate any form of misconduct.

Appropriate action will be taken against those found responsible. Further departmental action against the DTC driver for misconduct is also being initiated by the transport corporation, police said.

The incident has drawn attention to the conduct expected from personnel deployed in PCR vehicles, which are used for responding to emergency calls and maintaining public safety. Police said action followed departmental procedures. The viral video prompted online calls for accountability, while identities of those involved remained undisclosed. PTI

Prafull Singh breaks Guinness record across 254 Metro stations



AIMAN FATIMA

New Delhi, September 1

Delhi Metro Rail Corporation (DMRC) employee Prafull Singh has secured a Guinness World Record for completing the fastest journey across all stations of the Delhi Metro network, covering the entire challenge in 14 hours, 54 minutes and 36 seconds.

Singh undertook the journey on May 23, beginning at 6 am from Raja Nahar Singh station on the Violet Line and completing the route at Millennium City Centre station in Gurugram at around 9 pm.

He bettered the previous record of 15 hours, 21 minutes and four seconds, achieved by Sujoy Kumar Mitra and Shipra Gupta in June 2023. Singh had previously held the record in 2022, when he covered 254 stations in 16 hours, two minutes and 17 seconds. His latest attempt was aided by detailed route planning and his professional familiarity with the Delhi Metro network.

As a DMRC operations employee, Singh has extensive knowledge of train schedules, routes

and operational procedures, which helped him plan transfers and minimise delays.

"I was sure of breaking the Guinness World Record with a significant margin this time," Singh said to some media, recalling that his earlier attempt had been delayed by about one-and-a-half hours after he took an incorrect route.

The Guinness challenge involves specific verification requirements. For a station to be counted, the train must physically stop there. Participants are not required to disembark at every station, but must provide timestamped photographic evidence from each location.

Singh said the achievement was not merely a personal milestone but also an opportunity to highlight the scale and efficiency of Delhi Metro.

"This achievement is much more than a personal record for me," he said, adding that his association with DMRC provided him an opportunity to showcase the network's reach and efficiency and encourage greater use of public transport.

Homes to get rooftop solar with up to Rs 1.75L subsidy

Scheme to cover 2.3L households: CM Rekha Gupta

AIMAN FATIMA
New Delhi, September 1

Delhi is set to turn thousands of rooftops into mini power plants, with the government approving the second amendment to its Solar Energy Policy, offering up to 3-kW rooftop solar systems at zero upfront cost to eligible households consuming up to 400 units a month. While addressing the media Chief Minister Rekha Gupta and Power Minister Ashish Sood shared, the revised policy, was approved at the government's 40th Cabinet meeting on Tuesday, targets solar installations on 2.30 lakh rooftops and the addition of 500 MW of rooftop capacity.

Up to Rs 1.75 lakh support for 3-kW systems
Gupta said "households with average monthly consumption of up to 400 units in FY 2025-26 will be eligible, subject to technical feasibility."
The Centre will provide up to Rs 78,000, while Delhi will provide an equal capital subsidy and an additional top-up to bridge the gap between



IPGCL WILL SELECT VENDORS THROUGH COMPETITIVE BIDDING AND OVERSEE INSTALLATION, COORDINATION...

subsidy and tendered cost. For a 3-kW system costing around Rs 1.75 lakh, households consuming up to 400 units will effectively get the system free through the central and state subsidies and the additional Rs 19,000 top-up.
"The policy will enable people in Delhi to not only use electricity but also generate it," Gupta said.

Free power subsidy plus solar savings
Consumers using up to 200 units will continue receiving the existing 100 per cent electricity subsidy and will also benefit from solar-generated savings and payments for surplus power exported to the grid.
For a 2-kW system costing around Rs 1.30 lakh, consumers will receive Rs 60,000 central subsidy,

Rs 52,000 Delhi subsidy and Rs 18,000 top-up. A 3-kW system can generate around 300 units a month. For a 200-unit household, around 100 surplus units could be exported, giving an estimated additional benefit of Rs 950 per month. For households consuming 201-400 units, the estimated average monthly benefit is Rs 1,659.
For households consuming above 400 units, the 3-kW system will receive Rs 78,000 each from the Centre and Delhi, without the top-up, leaving a Rs 19,000 consumer contribution. Their estimated monthly benefit is Rs 2,143, with surplus power paid at Rs 6.50 per unit.

Maintenance and net metering eased
Vendors will provide

free operation and maintenance for five years, after which consumers can opt for services through discoms for the system's approximately 25-year lifespan. Net-metering processing has been reduced from 75 days to 25 days, while application and registration fees for systems up to 10 kW have been waived.
IPGCL will select vendors through competitive bidding and oversee installation, coordination and grievance redressal.

Housing societies also covered
A proposed 100-kW common-area system for group housing societies, costing Rs 45 lakh, will receive Rs 18 lakh central and Rs 11 lakh Delhi subsidy, leaving Rs 16 lakh consumer contribution. Its estimated monthly benefit is Rs 81,247.
"We have not only kept free electricity alive, but have secured and institutionalised it for the next 25 years," Power Minister Ashish Sood said.
Delhi currently has 10,073 installed solar systems, many on government buildings.

SIR: 20-45% voters excluded in draft rolls in minority-dominated, SC-reserved seats

OUR CORRESPONDENT
New Delhi, September 1

Minority-dominated and SC-reserved constituencies in the national capital registered between 20 and 45 per cent voter exclusions against the overall figure of 33 per cent deletions that Delhi recorded at the draft stage in the ongoing Special Intensive Revision (SIR) exercise.

Officials said among all states and Union Territories where SIR has been taken up, Delhi has recorded the "highest percentage" of deletions overall at 33 per cent at the draft stage.

Okhla, one of the seven constituencies where minorities are in sizeable numbers, recorded a staggering 45 per cent removal of voters in the draft rolls of the constituency while Patel Nagar (reserved) saw 42 per cent exclusions.

The draft electoral rolls of 70 assembly constituencies in Delhi were published by the Delhi chief electoral officer (CEO) office on Monday. Across 70 assembly segments, 47.5 lakh out of 1.45 crore voters have been excluded from the draft rolls.

Okhla, currently held by AAP MLA Amantullah Khan, had 3,62, 813 voters out of which 1,63,829 (45 per cent) have been



OKHLA, CURRENTLY HELD BY AAP MLA AMANTULLAH KHAN, HAD 3,62, 813 VOTERS OUT OF WHICH 1,63,829 (45%) HAVE BEEN EXCLUDED

excluded, leaving 1,98,984 voters in the draft rolls.

Other minority-dominated constituencies in Delhi besides Okhla witnessed relatively lower exclusions, including 38 per cent in Chandni Chowk, 32 per cent in Balimaran, 28 per cent in Mustafabad, 26 per cent in Babarpur, 24 per cent in Matia Mahal and 23 per cent in Seelampur. The excluded number of voters in these constituencies was 48,405 in Chandni Chowk, 80,804 in Mustafabad, 55,264 in Babarpur, 49,640 in Balliaraman, 45,105 in Seelampur and 32,099 in Matia Mahal.

Although there was no pattern of voter exclusion across the 70 constituencies, minority dominated

seats had witnessed relatively higher submission of enumeration forms as compared to general seats, during the door to door verification exercise from June 30 to August 17.

Digitisation of completed forms of voters was 76.6 per cent in Seelampur, followed by Matia Mahal with 75.5 per cent, Babarpur at 72.9 per cent and Mustafabad at 71.9 per cent. In the 12 SC-reserved seats in Delhi, 40 per cent voters in Karol Bagh were excluded in the draft rolls, followed by 39 per cent in Ambedkar Nagar, 37 per cent each in Deoli and Kondli, 33 per cent in Trilokpuri, and 31 per cent each in Seemapuri and Sultanpur Majra.

The reserved constitu-

encies that saw less than 30 per cent deletions were Gokalpur (25 per cent), Bawana (23 per cent), Madipur (23 per cent) and Mangol Puri (21 per cent).
The reserved constituencies with a high number of exclusions are Deoli (94,726), Patel Nagar (80,346), Kondli (75,930), Bawana (74,829), Karol Bagh (72,430), Seemapuri (68,227), Trilokpuri (63,582), Ambedkar Nagar (63,260) and Gokalpur (60,625).

According to the Delhi CEO office, the voters whose names are excluded from the draft rolls have been put under the absent, shifted, dead, duplicate and others (ASDDO) category.

The Delhi CEO data said the highest contributor to the ASDDO category was permanently shifted or absent voters -- 43,32,775 out of the total 47,56,722 voters have been excluded from the draft rolls.

The number of deceased voters was 2,82,412, while those enrolled at multiple places numbered 1,41,535.

The voters of the absent and shifted category can seek inclusion of their names in the final rolls to be published on November 4 by submitting Form 6 under the claims and objection phase, which will end on September 30.

Briefs

751 challans issued to motorists

NEW DELHI: The Delhi Traffic Police issued 751 challans in a day to motorists for riding two-wheelers without helmets during a special enforcement drive conducted across the northern range, an official said on Tuesday.
Traffic personnel were deployed at strategic locations to check violations of the mandatory helmet rule.
A total of 751 motorists were prosecuted for riding without helmets during the drive on August 31, they said.
The Traffic Police reiterated that wearing a helmet is not merely a legal requirement but an important safety measure that can help prevent fatal and serious injuries in road crashes.

NEB records 1,300+ corneal transplants

NEW DELHI: The National Eye Bank (NEB) at Dr Rajendra Prasad Centre for Ophthalmic Sciences performed over 1,300 corneal transplants for the fourth consecutive year, with 1,775 corneal blind patients receiving transplants in 2025. It recorded an 81.9 per cent tissue utilisation rate, above the national average.
NEB collected 2,167 corneas in 2025, with 1,775 retrieved through its Hospital Corneal Retrieval Programme. Over 61 years, it has collected more than 38,000 corneas and rehabilitated over 28,000 patients. It also performed 631 optical keratoplasties and supplied 4,652 preservation-media vials to 130 eye banks across 24 states.

Delhi Assembly premises to house modern museum

New Delhi, September 1

A modern, state-of-the-art museum will soon be developed at the Delhi Assembly to showcase the rich constitutional legacy and architectural heritage of the historic premises, Speaker Vijender Gupta said on Tuesday.
Addressing students at Delhi University, Gupta said the proposed museum would display rare historical artefacts, archival documents and interactive exhibits detailing the evolution of local governance.
By converting parts of the historic 1912 site into a curated public space, the Assembly Secretariat aims to provide visitors with a tangible connection to the foundational moments of the nation's legislative history, he said.
The speaker said the

DELHI ASSEMBLY BUILDING WAS CONSTRUCTED IN 1912

museum would serve as an experiential learning hub for the capital's youth and scholars.
"Giving citizens direct access to the seat of local democracy will foster a stronger sense of civic ownership and deepen public appreciation for India's democratic traditions," he said.
The Delhi Legislative Assembly building was constructed in 1912 and served as the temporary Central Secretariat and the seat of the Imperial Legislative Council after the capital of India was shifted from Calcutta to Delhi by the then British rulers. MPOST

Delhi L-G Sandhu seeks scientific overhaul of Capital's waste mgmt

SHIVANGI SHUKLA
New Delhi, September 1

Delhi Lieutenant Governor Taranjit Singh Sandhu on Tuesday called for Indore's successful waste management model to be studied and suitably replicated in the Capital, which generates around 13,000 metric tonnes of municipal waste every day. He said the focus must shift from "Waste to Landfill" to a "Waste-to-Wealth" approach.
Sandhu was speaking after inaugurating a one-day brainstorming workshop on municipal solid waste management, organised by the MCD in collaboration with IIT Delhi at the India International Centre. The workshop marks the first institutional collaboration between the civic body and a premier academic institution on solid waste management.
The L-G stressed source

“HE CALLED FOR COLLECTIVE RESPONSIBILITY INVOLVING CIVIC BODIES, PUBLIC REPRESENTATIVES, MKT ASSOCIATIONS

segregation of wet, dry, sanitary and domestic hazardous waste, along with the use of modern technology, digital monitoring, data management and advanced waste-processing systems.

He said scientific and sustainable waste management was closely linked to public health, environmental protection and quality of life.

He called for collective responsibility involving civic bodies, public representatives, RWAs, market associations, industries, institutions, experts and

citizens, with every household treated as an equal stakeholder. He said the workshop should deliver practical solutions, concrete action plans and measurable outcomes.

Delhi Mayor Praveesh Wahi highlighted landfill clearance, strengthened sanitation infrastructure and new machinery, and called for strict enforcement and model wards. Indore Mayor Pushyamitra Bhargav highlighted behavioural change, responsive governance and decentralised management through Zero Waste Wards, Colonies and Roads.

MCD Commissioner Sanjeev Khirwar said source segregation, scientific processing and resource recovery were priorities, with facilities being expanded to convert organic waste into compost and biogas and recover and recycle dry waste.

PLAN CLEARS WAY FOR SMALLER PLOT-BASED REDEVELOPMENT

‘MPD-2047 set to simplify approvals’

AIMAN FATIMA & SHIVANGI SHUKLA
New Delhi, September 1

Delhi's new master plan is set to move from policy to implementation, with the TOD committee scheduled to meet on September 3 to consider around seven proposals, some of which could also be sanctioned, Lieutenant Governor Taranjit Singh Sandhu told *Millennium Post*. He said MPD-2047 seeks to simplify approvals, clearly fix agency responsibilities and address long-standing challenges related to housing, water, greenery and infrastructure.
On regularisation and land-use provisions, Sandhu said, "Regularisation-related issues are going to be taken up by the government and are also being addressed. To facilitate construction

and improve urban living, MPD-2047 proposes simpler regulations and streamlined approval processes. For example, the number of permissible use premises will be reduced from 133 to 45, with a negative-list approach extended to residential, commercial and industrial areas to provide greater flexibility."
The plan also seeks to promote plot-based redevelopment by removing the existing minimum area requirement of four hectares. Commercial redevelopment will further benefit from higher FAR incentives, while the minimum plot size has been reduced to 1,000 sq m. Earlier, the negative list of permissible activities was applicable only to industrial areas; now, it has been specifically provided for residential and commercial areas as well.



He said MPD-2047 also clearly defines the responsibility of agencies, with DDA taking a greater role in planning and approvals, particularly for Transit-Oriented Development (TOD) projects. "Earlier, it was very clearly with the MCD, but now it lays down that it is the DDA's responsibility. A committee will decide who will approve the TOD project and coordinate planning with various agencies, so there is no blame game," he said.
Officials said the TOD committee will meet on September 3 to con-

sider the seven proposals received under the TOD policy announced on April, and some projects could also be in a position to get sanctioned after the discussion. The DDA has received a good response from both private and government entities, officials said.

"Some schemes like TOD and SDC do not require additional regulations because they are already laid down in the Master Plan. We have received seven TOD proposals and are moving ahead with them. Land pooling, however, requires regulations, which will clearly lay down the details of the PPP scheme and other possible models," Sandhu said.

Officials said wherever additional regulations are required, these are expected to be brought

out within the next two to three months.

On transparency, officials said developers would be able to apply online and track their projects, while DDA would be responsible for ensuring accountability. MPD-2047 also provides for a Rs.10,000-per-square-metre TOD charge, which developers will deposit with DDA. A specified share would subsequently be transferred to agencies including DJB and MCD for infrastructure development.

MPD-2047 proposes smaller 20-hectare landpooling sectors with a 60:40 landowner-DDA share. Mixed-use development could allow limited commercial activity along wider roads, while active Yamuna floodplains will remain construction-free. Sandhu has consulted around 45 MLAs and MPs.

City steps up pollution checks ahead of winter

OUR CORRESPONDENT
New Delhi, September 1

Delhi government steps up preparations for the pollution season, identifying nearly 78,000 Delhi-registered BS-III and BS-IV heavy vehicles for voluntary transition to cleaner BS-VI models, while constituting district-level task forces to tackle local pollution and traffic hotspots.

Officials said deputy commissioners, district magistrates and other officials have been tasked with identifying hotspots and proposing area-specific engineering solutions by the end of September. The vehicle transition drive is part of the Centre's Rs 9,585-crore Parivartan scheme, which offers incentives for eligible owners shifting to BS-VI diesel/CNG or electric commercial vehicles.

The government has also expanded construction and demolition waste collection sites from 106 to 125 and intensified dust monitoring through its AI-enabled anti-pollution portal, which has flagged around 2,000 sites violating prescribed measures.

On industrial emissions, air-quality control devices have been made mandatory for 80 categories of industries, while more than 90 industries must install Online Emission Monitoring Systems (OEMS).

The Delhi government has planted around 60 lakh of its targeted 70-lakh trees and identified nearly 3,000 environmental volunteers. Stricter pollution-control measures will take effect from November 1 under Section 5 of the Environment Protection Act, regardless of the GRAP stage.

From page 1

SC quashes

stringent action would be taken. Nadda said he and Union minister Jitendra Singh had met representatives of the students at Jantar Mantar that day. “The welfare and progress of the country’s youth remains the government’s utmost priority,” Nadda told reporters. He also welcomed the withdrawal of the September 5 protest.

Das told the court that, following the government’s assurances and the judicial order, the CJP had decided to withdraw its proposed march from India Gate to Delhi Police Headquarters. The organisation had announced the mobilisation on August 24, alleging that commitments made on July 25 had not been fully honoured.

CJP founder Abhijeet Dipke described Tuesday’s ruling as “absolute justice” and said the group’s demands had been met. He also apologised to families who had lost their children and called for steps to prevent students from losing their lives because of failures in the examination system.

Advocate Vrinda Grover, who represented the CJP, called the ruling “historic and significant”, saying it recognised the importance of the right to protest and seek accountability.

The protests had begun at Jantar Mantar on June 20 and continued for 36 days before being called off on July 25. The agitation spread to several cities and included a July 20 march in Delhi, where protesters attempting to move towards Parliament clashed with security personnel. Police used lathis and tear-gas shells to disperse the crowd.

The agitation had sought, among other demands, the resignation of then Union Education Minister Dharmendra Pradhan. The protests were withdrawn on July 25 after Pradhan resigned and the government accepted the CJP’s other demands.

Modi calls

PM Modi’s comments directly referred to Pakistan’s longtime policy of supporting terror groups to attack India. The killings of tourists in Jammu and Kashmir’s Pahalgam by Pakistan-linked terrorists last year had drawn a major response from India in the form of Operation Sindoor. Indian cruise missiles and drones had slammed into infrastructure deep inside Pakistan used for training terrorists and Pakistani military assets.

He said there is no solution on the battlefield and all wars and conflicts should be resolved through dialogue and diplomacy. The regional grouping SCO’s summit comes amid the war in the Middle East that has affected global energy supply lines and many economies.

The prime minister, in an apparent reference to China’s Belt and Road Initiative (BRI), said connectivity projects should respect the sovereignty and territorial integrity of all countries as it is the fundamental spirit of the SCO Charter.

India has been critical of BRI as part of it passes through Pakistan-occupied Kashmir.

However, the central theme of the prime minister’s address appeared to be his call to the SCO to work unitedly to combat terrorism. “Terrorism continues to pose a serious challenge to humanity as a whole. In the fight against terrorism, we cannot remain con-

fined to an action-reaction approach,” he said.

The prime minister also touched upon the importance of peace and stability for a peaceful Eurasia.

“Our shared aspiration for a peaceful and secure Eurasia is also closely linked to peace and stability in Afghanistan. India has been contributing to the development and provision of humanitarian assistance to the people of Afghanistan and will continue to do so,” he said.

Modi also underlined the importance of improving connectivity and said India supports all efforts that connect markets, facilitate trade, and open up new avenues for development.

Modi’s address was based on three pillars – security, connectivity, and opportunity – that he had proposed for India’s vision for the SCO at the last summit of the grouping. The prime minister said the SCO cooperation should reach people directly.

The Ministry of External Affairs (MEA) listed 13 outcomes, one of which was the approval of regulations for a “Universal Centre for Countering Challenges and Threats to the Security of SCO Member States”.

The Centre is expected to strengthen cooperation among SCO members in tackling terrorism, extremism, organised crime and other transnational threats, and enable better coordination and information sharing, the MEA said in a post on X.

Among the outcomes highlighted by the MEA is the Bishkek Declaration, which is expected to provide India a platform to articulate its positions on regional security, development and connectivity, and strengthen its engagement with Central Asia and the wider Eurasian region.

The SCO is a political, economic and security grouping founded in 2001 by China, Kazakhstan, Kyrgyzstan, Russia, Tajikistan and Uzbekistan. It has since expanded to include India, Pakistan, Iran and Belarus as full members, with several other countries holding observer or dialogue-partner status.

The grouping marked its 25th anniversary this year, with the summit held in Bishkek under Kyrgyzstan’s chairmanship.

Centre halves

2,000 quintals at any location across the country.

The ministry said Kolkata had been given an exception because the region sources sugar from Uttar Pradesh and Maharashtra and supplies it to eastern and north-eastern states.

The move comes as sugar prices remain high. The all-India average retail price reached Rs 63.28 per kg on August 31, up 37 per cent from Rs 46.02 per kg a year earlier, Consumer Affairs Ministry data showed. Wholesale prices increased 36.28 per cent year-on-year to Rs 58.40 per kg.

At the mill level, prices have eased. The ex-mill price in Maharashtra fell 30 per cent to Rs 45-46 per kg on September 1 from Rs 67 per kg on August 18.

The Centre has accused mills of “jacking up” prices while maintaining that sugar stocks are adequate. Production for the 2025-26 marketing year has, however, been revised down to 306 lakh tonnes from 343 lakh tonnes. Annual domestic demand is estimated at 280-285 lakh tonnes.

Nepal

Chitwan recorded the highest number of recovered bodies at 321, followed by Nawalparasi East with 216 and Nawalparasi West with 170. Nuwa-

kot reported 95 deaths, Gorkha 65, Dhading 57, Rasuwa 41 and Tanahun 38.

Hospitals are facing difficulties handling the large number of unidentified victims. Crowds have gathered at medical facilities as families carry photographs of missing relatives and check images of recovered bodies displayed on walls. Unidentified bodies are currently being kept at 21 hospitals.

Identification has been complicated by severe decomposition and partial remains, particularly among bodies recovered after being carried long distances by floodwaters. Officials said only about 60 bodies had been handed over to families following identification, while nearly 700 had been buried after documentation and preservation of identification records.

Rescue teams are also searching for more than 600 workers and employees at hydropower sites, many of whom are believed to be trapped inside tunnels. Teams from India and China are assisting Nepalese authorities.

Indian Ambassador to Nepal Naveen Srivastava said India’s specialised tunnel rescue team had established a foothold inside a tunnel at Chilime and reached 185 metres inside another tunnel at Langtang. The operations were carried out with the Nepali Army despite poor weather and difficult access.

Water, mud and debris have blocked tunnel entrances, while damaged roads and difficult terrain have slowed movement. Limited specialised equipment and technical expertise at some locations have added to the difficulties.

Nepal also remains at risk of further flooding. Authorities issued a fresh alert covering eastern, central and western districts, warning residents near rivers to remain cautious. Nuwakot and Rasuwa face a high possibility of flash floods, while several other districts face moderate risks.

Officials are monitoring the Koshi, Narayani, Bagmati, Karnali and Mahakali rivers and their tributaries, along with the Kankai, Kamala, Babai, Eastern Rapti and Western Rapti rivers.

A real-time CCTV camera has been installed at Timure in Rasuwa to monitor river conditions near the border. Its footage will be linked with the 24-hour flood forecast and early warning service. Authorities are also working to operationalise VSAT communication systems that can transmit real-time hydrological and meteorological data from remote areas.

Energy Minister Biraj Bhakta Shrestha held discussions with officials and experts on weather conditions, river monitoring and flood preparedness in affected areas including Rasuwa and Nuwakot.

More than 21,300 security personnel have been deployed for rescue and relief operations, with helicopters conducting repeated evacuations and supply missions.

The floods destroyed 19 motorable bridges and several highways, including the main land trade route to China and the Rasuwagadhi border crossing.

Traffic restrictions have also been introduced on the Prithvi and Tribhuvan highways because of increased pressure following damage in Rasuwa, Nuwakot and Dhading. Vehicles carrying up to 14 passengers travelling from Kathmandu to Hetauda have been diverted through Farping, Fakhel,

Kulekhani and Bhimfedi, while Hetauda-Kathmandu traffic is being routed through Bhimfedi, Kulekhani, Sisneri and Dakshinkali.

Larger vehicles travelling between the two cities are being directed to the Tribhuvan and Kanti highways in separate directions after flooding washed away part of the highway at Krishnabhir in Dhading.

SC seeks Centre’s view

together rather than separately. The petitioners said such a system would help protect voter privacy by preventing the voting pattern of individual localities from becoming publicly identifiable.

“The Union of India may examine the issue of carrying out the necessary amendment in the Conduct of Elections Rules for introduction of totalisers for counting of votes recorded in EVMs,” the bench said.

The court also asked the Centre to examine the relevant provisions of the Conduct of Elections Rules, 1961, along with recommendations of the Law Commission of India that included a proposed provision for vote totalisation.

“We would like to know what are the impediments, if any, and whether there would be any negative impact because of introduction of such a mechanism,” the bench said.

Advocate Ashwini Upadhyay, one of the petitioners, told the court that totalisers were being sought to safeguard the privacy of voters and reduce the possibility of post-poll violence. He said several countries already use the system for these purposes.

Upadhyay also said the Election Commission of India had supported the introduction of totalisers from 2007 until recently.

However, counsel for the Election Commission told the court that there were several hurdles to introducing the mechanism and that a majority of political parties had not agreed to it.

The proceedings were part of a wider petition filed by Upadhyay, Yogesh Gupta and others seeking common electoral rolls for Parliament, Assembly and local body elections, along with measures to save public money and manpower.

The petitioners also challenged the current polling station-wise counting arrangement, saying it can reveal voting patterns in specific localities or pockets.

CBI pending trials

Of the total cases, 739 were pending for more than 20 years, 1,347 for over 15 years but less than 20 years, and 3,161 for more than 10 years but less than 15 years, the report said.

A total of 3,854 such appeals and revisions were pending for more than five years but less than 10 years, 1,987 for over two years but less than five years and 2,995 for less than two years, the report made public recently said.

There were 473 corruption cases pending investigation with the CBI, 39 of them for more than five years, 37 for over three years but less than five years and 33 for more than two years but less than three years, it said.

As many as 72 cases were pending investigation for more than one year but less than two years and 292 for less than one year, as on December 31, 2025.

“It is expected of CBI to complete investigation within one year of regis-

tration of a case. Completion of investigation would imply filing of chargesheet in a court of law wherever warranted, after receipt of sanction from the competent authority, if required,” the report said.

However, some delay has been observed in completion of investigation in certain cases, including “delay in obtaining responses to Letters Rogatory (LRs)” and “time consumed in verification of documents/title deeds, etc., in disproportionate asset cases”, among others, the report said.

It cited “delay in providing relevant records/documents by the authorities concerned”, “time-consuming efforts required for scrutiny of voluminous records, especially in economic offences and bank fraud cases”, and “time and efforts required to locate and examine witnesses available at remote locations” as reasons for delay in completion of investigation.

In 2025, the CBI registered 1,005 regular cases/preliminary inquiries/Lokpal references.

A total of 265 traps were laid for the detection of bribery cases last year, while 81 regular cases for possession of disproportionate assets were registered during the same period, it said.

Out of 1,005 cases, 161 cases were taken up on the orders of the Constitutional courts and 27 cases on the references received from state governments/Union territories.

As many as 615 corruption-related cases were registered by the CBI in 2025, involving 855 public servants (237 gazetted officers). A total of 654 cases were disposed of last year, the report said.

Thirty-four department cases were pending against CBI officers – 21 against Group A officers and 13 against Group B and C officers – at various stages, it said.

Of these, eight were pending for more than four years, it added.

Tech layoffs

management. Employees who do not meet the expectations of their roles may receive coaching, be placed on a PIP, offered voluntary separation or be terminated.

“The share of employees globally on PIPs is a very small percentage,” a Microsoft spokesperson said, while declining to provide regional details or comment on individual personnel matters.

Gaurav Vasu, chief executive of market research firm Unearthinsight, said PIP-related exits generally account for around 1 per cent to 2 per cent of a company’s workforce and can result from either performance issues or a mismatch between employee skills and changing requirements.

Oracle is facing a larger workforce restructuring in India. Jain estimated that between 2,000 and 3,000 employees could be affected, with the cuts expected to take effect from September 1. Oracle employs about 30,000 people in India and had already eliminated around 12,000 jobs in an earlier round.

The latest restructuring reflects a wider shift in the skills technology companies are seeking. Vasu said Oracle is moving budgets away from legacy sales capabilities towards newer areas, describing the changes as an AI-led restructuring involving a combination of PIPs and workforce reallocation.

Kamal Karanth, co-founder of staffing firm

Xpheno, said PIPs should not be viewed simply as an alternative to layoffs because their purpose is to give employees an opportunity to improve. He also said AI’s impact on engineering jobs is likely to become clearer over the next two to three years, particularly for junior and mid-level engineers working on lower-complexity tasks.

The pressure is also reaching India’s entry-level technology market. Large companies have become more cautious about campus recruitment, while some fresh graduates have faced long delays before joining jobs they have already been offered. IBM, Accenture, Oracle Financial Services Software and Cognizant have previously told candidates that joining dates could depend on project availability, business requirements and administrative processes. Some graduates have consequently waited months, and in some cases more than a year, to begin employment.

Recruitment is increasingly being tied to actual project demand instead of large-scale hiring to maintain bench strength. This shift is reflected in the broader employment numbers. India’s five largest IT companies recorded a combined net workforce reduction of 6,981 employees in FY26, compared with a net addition of 12,718 employees in FY25. Nasscom estimates that the industry’s total workforce grew by only 1.35 lakh to 5.9 million in 2026.

There are signs that hiring may be stabilising in parts of the sector. India’s six largest IT companies added a combined 5,400 employees in the first quarter of FY27, reversing a net reduction of 7,100 jobs in the previous quarter. Tata Consultancy Services accounted for much of that increase, adding 9,000 employees during the quarter, its largest quarterly workforce addition in three years.

Global Capability Centres are also becoming important sources of technology employment in India. However, HR professionals say GCC recruitment is not a direct replacement for traditional campus hiring. These centres increasingly seek specialised talent in areas such as AI, data analytics, product development, cybersecurity and digital engineering.

The global figures show that workforce restructuring extends well beyond India. Oracle said in a June 23 financial filing that it had cut about 21,000 jobs over the previous year, equivalent to roughly 13 per cent of its workforce.

In July, Microsoft announced another 4,800 job cuts, around 2.1 per cent of its workforce, with its Xbox gaming operations among the areas most affected. Xbox chief Asha Sharma said about 3,200 Xbox roles would be eliminated through fiscal 2027, including 1,600 cuts announced on July 6. Visa is cutting around 2,600 positions, or 7 per cent of its workforce, mainly in technology and product teams. Monday.com is eliminating about 630 jobs, or 20 per cent of its workforce, as it makes AI a larger part of its operations. Uber has reportedly reduced its customer service workforce by 10 per cent, while Amazon is cutting jobs in its artificial general intelligence group and narrowing its focus to AI projects it considers most important to customers.

The cuts continued through May and June. Intuit announced plans to eliminate about 3,000 jobs, or 17 per cent of its work-

force, while Meta began cutting around 8,000 jobs, or 10 per cent of its workforce, and planned to eliminate another 6,000 open positions. Cisco plans to cut just under 4,000 jobs in the fourth quarter while increasing investment in areas including silicon, optics, security and AI. Cloudflare is cutting more than 1,100 employees, PayPal plans to eliminate nearly 4,800 jobs, or about 20 per cent of its workforce, and Coinbase is cutting 700 positions, or about 14 per cent.

Other companies have also reduced headcount. Snap announced 1,000 layoffs, equal to 16 per cent of its workforce, while Disney announced 1,000 cuts and Marvel reduced its workforce by 8 per cent. Meta cut another 200 workers in the Bay Area in April and around 700 employees in March. Epic Games laid off more than 1,000 workers after weaker engagement with Fortnite reduced revenue. Chief executive Tim Sweeney said those cuts were not caused by AI.

Apple has joined the latest wave, cutting at least 60 employees from its Vision Group, which works on the Vision Pro headset. The company is also reducing jobs in its Intelligent Systems Experience group, which is involved in AI systems used across Apple devices.

The layoffs show that AI is a significant factor behind workforce changes, but it is not the sole cause. Companies have also cited weaker demand, restructuring, changing business plans, cost reduction and poor performance in particular areas. Etsy has said its layoffs were not driven by AI, while Disney and General Motors have pointed to restructuring and changing business requirements. The 2026 employment picture therefore reflects both the rapid adoption of AI and a broader reassessment by technology companies of which skills, teams and businesses they need for their next phase of growth.

Journalist challenges

Upadhyay’s journalistic sources to state authorities. The Court said it would examine the concerns.

On August 25, the Supreme Court had granted Upadhyay interim protection from arrest in the road rage case. The FIR was filed after a motorcyclist alleged that Upadhyay hit his vehicle and threatened and abused him.

Upadhyay has claimed the case, which also invokes the SC/ST Act, was retaliation for his reporting on the Ram Temple Trust and alleged corruption in Uttar Pradesh. He has also alleged that CCTV footage was suppressed and said the two-wheeler’s owner was not the complainant. The Supreme Court has sought the Uttar Pradesh government’s response. The matter will next be heard on September 7.

ATF price,

The cuts followed a sharp rise in June, when the West Asia conflict pushed commercial LPG prices to a record Rs 3,113.50 per 19-kg cylinder. From February’s Rs 1,740.50, the rate had risen by Rs 1,373.

ATF and LPG prices are revised monthly based on international benchmarks and foreign exchange rates, with state-level taxes causing variations.

Domestic LPG remains unchanged at Rs 942 per 14.2-kg cylinder. Petrol and diesel prices also remain unchanged after May’s Rs 7.50 per litre increase. MPOST

REVIVES SWADESHI PITCH AMID INDIA'S GDP GROWTH

PM Modi says ‘Don’t buy gold, don’t marry abroad’

OUR CORRESPONDENT
New Delhi, September 1

Prime Minister Narendra Modi on Tuesday applauded the country's people for the 7.8 per cent GDP growth rate, calling the feat particularly impressive, coming against the backdrop of global turmoil, geopolitical conflicts, and supply chain disruptions.

As PM Modi congratulated the country on GDP growth, he once again appealed to citizens to renew their pledge for an Atmanirbhar (self-reliant) Bharat.

Modi asked Indians to shun leisure trips abroad, avoid getting married overseas and refrain from buying gold unless necessary.

In a video message on Instagram, the Prime Minister also slammed those spreading “jhooth ki goonj” (an apparent riff on Rahul Gandhi's ‘Chhatron ki Goonj’ campaign), saying the latest GDP growth rate tore through the narrative of “pessimism” about the Indian economy.

Modi said India must maintain the growth momentum and continue working towards greater self-reliance and ‘Swadeshi’.

“We must maintain this momentum. We must keep moving forward, and for that, becoming Atmanirbhar Bharat is essential,” he said.

Briefs

Nabin meets Russian envoy

NEW DELHI: BJP president Nitin Nabin on Tuesday met Russian Ambassador to India Denis Alipov at the party headquarters, with the interaction focusing on the “long-standing and time-tested India-Russia relationships”.

During the meeting, Nabin highlighted the strong, personal understanding and trust between PM Modi and Russian President Putin.

Two MNS workers held

PUNE: Police have arrested two workers of the Maharashtra Navnirman Sena (MNS) in connection with the alleged removal of a photograph of Prime Minister Narendra Modi in the Government Polytechnic in Pune, officials said on Tuesday. Tensions also flared in Mumbai, as BJP youth wing workers clashed with MNS activists over the issue.

Punjab: AAP protests against BJP

CHANDIGARH: Punjab's ruling party AAP on Tuesday held protests in Ludhiana, Jalandhar, Amritsar and Bathinda against the BJP for its three MPs visiting the residence of former Congress MP Sajjan Kumar to offer condolences after his death. AAP demanded that the BJP take action against the three MPs.



Prime Minister Narendra Modi at the Shanghai Cooperation Organization (SCO) Council of Heads of State Meeting, in Bishkek, Kyrgyzstan

HIGHLIGHTS

» PM once again appealed to citizens to renew their pledge for an Atmanirbhar (self-reliant) Bharat

» Modi said India must maintain the growth momentum and continue working towards greater self-reliance and ‘Swadeshi’

The prime minister said if people continue to stress on Swadeshi and self-reliance, the country's youth will be presented with a developed India in the 100th year of Independence.

The prime minister said that since the 2020 COVID Pandemic, there has been no stability anywhere, yet India progressed well.

“On the other hand, people mired in despair are busy spreading ‘jhooth

ki goonj’ and pessimism all around,” he said.

He said India's high GDP growth came as the world remains beset by many crises and supply chain disruptions.

“We have to maintain the speed of our growth. We have to grow. And for that we must become self-reliant. The youth's dreams need our hard work to be realised. Let's not be lacking in efforts,” he said.

Modi said his government's policies are good, its intention clear, and that is why the country is reaching new heights of progress.

India's economy grew at a faster-than-expected 7.8 per cent in the April-June quarter, showing resilience against concerns of an economic downturn over the war in West Asia.

Gross domestic product (GDP) growth in the first quarter of the 2026-27 fiscal year slowed from a barnstorming 8.6 per cent in the previous quarter, but remained well above expectations when the conflict erupted and disrupted energy markets.

The Prime Minister on Monday described the growth number as a “herculean feat.”

No chance of accountability: Rahul Slams Centre, UP govt after gang-rape on moving bus

OUR CORRESPONDENT
New Delhi, September 1

Congress leader Rahul Gandhi on Tuesday lashed out at the Centre and the Uttar Pradesh government over the alleged gang-rape of a minor in a moving bus in Noida, and said there was no chance of any accountability being fixed for the police under Union Home Minister Amit Shah and Chief Minister Yogi Adityanath as this crime too shall have a curtain drawn over it.

The Leader of Opposition in the Lok Sabha said Delhi-NCR has become so unsafe for women that a minor girl was gang-raped for 47 km in a sleeper bus from Greater Noida to Delhi.

It's astonishing that neither the entire Delhi police nor the Noida police had the slightest inkling of it, Gandhi said in a post in Hindi on X.

“This bus crossed the Noida-Greater Noida Expressway, Delhi's Ring

CSE 2025: Supreme Court to hear Centre's plea on OBC creamy-layer rule

Bench issued notice and asked parties to file their responses by Sept 17

OUR CORRESPONDENT
New Delhi, September 1

The Supreme Court on Tuesday agreed to consider the Centre's plea seeking clarification on the applicability of its March 11 judgement on OBC creamy-layer criteria on candidates of the Civil Services Examination (CSE) 2025.

A bench of Justices PS Narasimha and R Mahadevan issued notice on the Centre's plea and asked the parties to file their responses by September 17.

Solicitor General Tushar Mehta, appearing for the Centre, submitted that there are serious practical difficulties in implementing the March 11 decision this year as candidates are waiting for their posting and will be affected.



Senior advocates Sanjay Hegde and P Wilson, appearing for some of the original petitioners, said that they have a preliminary objection on the maintainability of the petition filed by the Centre.

Hegde said that the Centre has filed a miscellaneous application for clarification of the verdict and it is not a review petition.

Mehta submitted that there are several judgments in their favour and can address the issue of maintainability, if raised by

the opposite parties.

The bench said it is posting the matter for hearing on September 17 and the petitioners can raise the issue of maintainability of the petition on that day.

On August 25, the top court said it would constitute a special bench to hear Centre's plea for clarification on the applicability of its March 11 judgement.

The Department of Personnel and Training (DoPT) has sought directions allowing the government to proceed with service allocation of the 958 candidates recommended by the Union Public Service Commission (UPSC) for CSE-2025 on the basis of the OBC creamy-layer determination applied before the March 11 verdict.

The DoPT's plea arises

from the top court's judgement in a case titled Union of India vs Rohith Nathan, in which the court, on March 11 held, among other things, that the October 14, 2004 clarifying letter could not override the September 8, 1993 office memorandum governing identification of the OBC creamy layer.

The court also held that the salary or income of a parent employed in a public sector undertaking or the private sector could not by itself be treated as the determinative criterion for creamy-layer exclusion.

The status and category of the parent's post, along with the prescribed income/wealth test, were to be considered in accordance with the 1993 office memorandum.

Congress attacks govt's GDP figures

OUR CORRESPONDENT
New Delhi, September 1

The Congress on Tuesday attacked the Modi government's latest GDP figures, alleging the administration has repeatedly changed methodology to inflate growth numbers while the real economic situation remains bleak.

Congress general secretary in-charge communications Jairam Ramesh claimed that if the Modi government released actual figures, the growth rate would be substantially lower. He pointed to a discrepancy between nominal and real GDP, which the government pegs at 2.3 per cent, while Wholesale Price Index inflation stands above 9 per cent. “Yesterday's GDP numbers are simply statistical gymnastics,” Ramesh said. The government changed its GDP calculation methodology twice this year, moving away from the WPI in June, he said.

The April-June quarter registered 7.8 per cent growth, down from 8.6 per cent in the previous quarter.

In a press conference, Party leader Salman Soz questioned the disconnect between headline growth and ground-level conditions. After a decade of Make in India, manufacturing's share of GDP remains below 13 per cent, he said. India's trade deficit with China stands at \$112 billion despite government rhetoric on “Vocal for Local”, he added.

Soz cited persistent problems: retail inflation at 3.9 per cent, youth unemployment at 16 per cent, stagnant private investment and rural wages barely above inflation levels.

Chhattisgarh CM launches TIN Portal

OUR CORRESPONDENT
Raipur, September 1

The Chhattisgarh government has taken a major step to ensure that tribal communities in Bastar get a fair and transparent price for the tin ore they collect.

Chief Minister Vishnu Deo Sai on Tuesday launched the TIN (Tribal Incentives on Natural Resources) Portal, a digital platform that will bring the entire process of tin procurement—from registration and quality testing to price determination and payment—under one transparent system.



The key feature of the portal is that the price of tin will be linked to the London Metal Exchange (LME), allowing payments to better reflect prevailing international market prices. Once the tin is sold, the payment will be transferred directly to the beneficiary's bank account

Ajay Rai files defamation case against CM Yogi

BISWAJEET BANERJEE
Lucknow, September 1

Uttar Pradesh Congress president and former minister Ajay Rai on Tuesday filed a defamation case against Chief Minister Yogi Adityanath, alleging that remarks made against him over eating fish in Ayodhya were false and objectionable.

Rai filed the defamation claim in a civil court in Lucknow, saying the allegations had caused him hurt and were aimed at damaging his public image and reputation.

The Congress leader alleged that false facts were presented about him and said making baseless allegations against a person in public life was a serious matter.

Rai said he had approached the court to seek legal remedy and would respond to the allegations through the judicial process.



The suspected sleeper bus after a 16-year-old girl was allegedly gang-raped inside it

Road, the border -- all of it -- without being stopped even once at a single checkpoint. Curtains were drawn over the bus seats so no one could see what was happening inside. And the perpetrators had no fear of the administration whatsoever,” he said.

Even after so many years since the ‘Nirbhaya’ case, after so many such incidents, why are the rules for checking and monitoring such buses still not being followed, Gandhi asked.

“Those curtains weren't just drawn on that one bus - it is the result of curtains

being drawn year after year by the government over the administration's failures, leaving women unable even to take a safe journey in the country's capital,” the former Congress chief said.

How many more women and girls will have to endure this before the central and state governments finally fix this system, Gandhi asked.

“Will there be any accountability for the Delhi Police under Amit Shah, or the UP Police under Adityanath? Not a chance - this crime, too, will just have a curtain drawn over it,” he said.

Govt to SC: 30,458 gender-segregated toilets constructed in schools

The bench, which posted matter for September 29, said focus should be more on schools in rural areas

OUR CORRESPONDENT
New Delhi, September 1

The Centre on Tuesday informed the Supreme Court that 30,458 gender-segregated toilets with washing facilities have been constructed in schools across the country while 4,236 are under construction.

The government also told a bench of Justices J B Pardiwala and R Mahadevan that all the states and Union Territories (UTs) have started providing sanitary napkins to educational institutions like schools.

Additional Solicitor



General Aishwarya Bhati, appearing for the Centre, told the bench that they have filed a compliance affidavit giving details for the last quarter.

“States and Union Territories have reported that 77 per cent, that is 30,458 gender-segre-

gated toilets with washing facilities have been constructed. Eleven per cent, that is 4,236, are under construction and there is a gap of 12 per cent, that is 4,745,” Bhati told the bench.

In a judgement delivered on January 30, the

apex court had said that right to life under Article 21 of the Constitution includes the right to menstrual health.

It had directed the states and UTs to ensure that every school, whether government-run or privately managed,

in both urban and rural areas, was provided with functional, gender-segregated toilets with usable water connectivity.

The top court had also directed all the states and UTs to ensure that every school provides sanitary napkins to girl students

KEY POINTS

» In a judgement delivered on January 30, the apex court had said that right to life under Article 21 of the Constitution includes the right to menstrual health

» The top court had also directed all the states and UTs to ensure that every school provides sanitary napkins to girl students free of cost

free of cost.

On Tuesday, the top court asked Bhati how many states have started providing sanitary napkins.

“All have started,” the law officer said.

“How do you propose to ensure as the Union that these directions are given effect in letter and spirit?” the bench asked.

Bhati said the Centre was “hand-holding” the states and UTs.

“We are having collaborative efforts. We are also providing funds under two schemes -- National Health Mission through the Ministry of Health and

Family Welfare and also under the ‘Samagra Shiksha Abhiyan’,” she said.

Bhati said the compliance affidavit contains compilation of data provided by all the states and UTs.

The bench, which posted the matter for September 29, said the focus should be more on schools in the rural areas.

In its January 30 verdict, the top court had issued a slew of directions to all states and UTs to ensure that these facilities were provided in schools irrespective of whether they were government-run, aided or private.

EDITORIAL

Protecting Rural Livelihoods

India's economy may be displaying considerable resilience, but an old vulnerability is again threatening to test it. The Finance Ministry's latest Monthly Economic Review has flagged an intensifying El Niño as a risk to agricultural production and inflation, particularly as its effects could extend into the upcoming rabi season. The warning comes after August recorded a 16 per cent rainfall deficit and the India Meteorological Department forecast below-normal rainfall for September. India has travelled a considerable distance in agricultural production, technology and food security, yet the fortunes of millions of farmers remain disproportionately tied to the behaviour of the monsoon.

The vulnerability is hardly new. Large parts of Indian agriculture remain rain-fed, making not merely the quantum but also the timing and geographical distribution of rainfall crucial. A weak monsoon can reduce yields, while prolonged dry spells followed by intense rainfall can be equally destructive. The consequences travel far beyond farms. Lower production of pulses, oilseeds and vegetables can push up food prices, squeeze household budgets, weaken rural consumption and eventually complicate monetary policy. El Niño therefore represents not simply an agricultural risk but a broader economic one. The government has recognised the immediate challenge, updating district-level contingency plans, promoting short-duration and low-water crops and reviewing preparedness with states. Such measures are necessary, but recurring weather emergencies cannot perpetually be addressed through contingency planning.

The larger task is to make agriculture structurally less vulnerable to climate variability. Irrigation expansion remains essential, but building canals and extracting groundwater cannot constitute the entire answer. Micro-irrigation, watershed restoration, rainwater harvesting and more efficient management of existing reservoirs require much greater emphasis. Crop choices must increasingly reflect local water availability rather than incentives that encourage water-intensive cultivation in unsuitable regions. Agricultural research must simultaneously accelerate the development and adoption of drought-, heat- and flood-tolerant varieties. Weather forecasting has improved substantially, but its value ultimately depends on whether a farmer receives reliable, localised and actionable advice before deciding when and what to sow.

Insurance must form another pillar of climate resilience. Crop insurance can protect incomes after disaster strikes, but delayed assessments and payments diminish its effectiveness. Technology should permit faster loss estimation and settlement while ensuring that small and tenant farmers are adequately covered. Equally important is strengthening storage, procurement and food buffers so that a climatic shock does not automatically become an inflationary shock.

Climate change is making the old assumption of a broadly predictable monsoon increasingly unreliable. India cannot control El Niño, but it can determine how severely El Niño affects its farmers and economy. After decades of agricultural modernisation, success should no longer be measured merely by record harvests in favourable years. The real test is whether Indian agriculture can withstand an unfavourable year without pushing farmers into distress or consumers towards higher prices. Climate-proofing agriculture must move from emergency preparedness to permanent policy.

LETTER



letter2editor.mp@gmail.com.

Energy Security

Oil crossing \$92 a barrel once again exposes India's vulnerability to global energy shocks. Higher crude prices threaten inflation, the rupee and economic growth. India must accelerate renewables, electric mobility, storage and public transport while reducing petroleum dependence. Energy transition is now as much about economic security as climate action.

RAMANAND KUMAR,
PATNA

You can also send your comments to The Editor, Millennium Post, Pratap Bhawan, 5 Bahadur Shah Zafar Marg, New Delhi 110 002

Conundrum of Defection in Politics

Recent political defections expose enduring loopholes in India's anti-defection framework and strengthen the case for long-pending institutional reforms

SHIFTING LOYALTIES

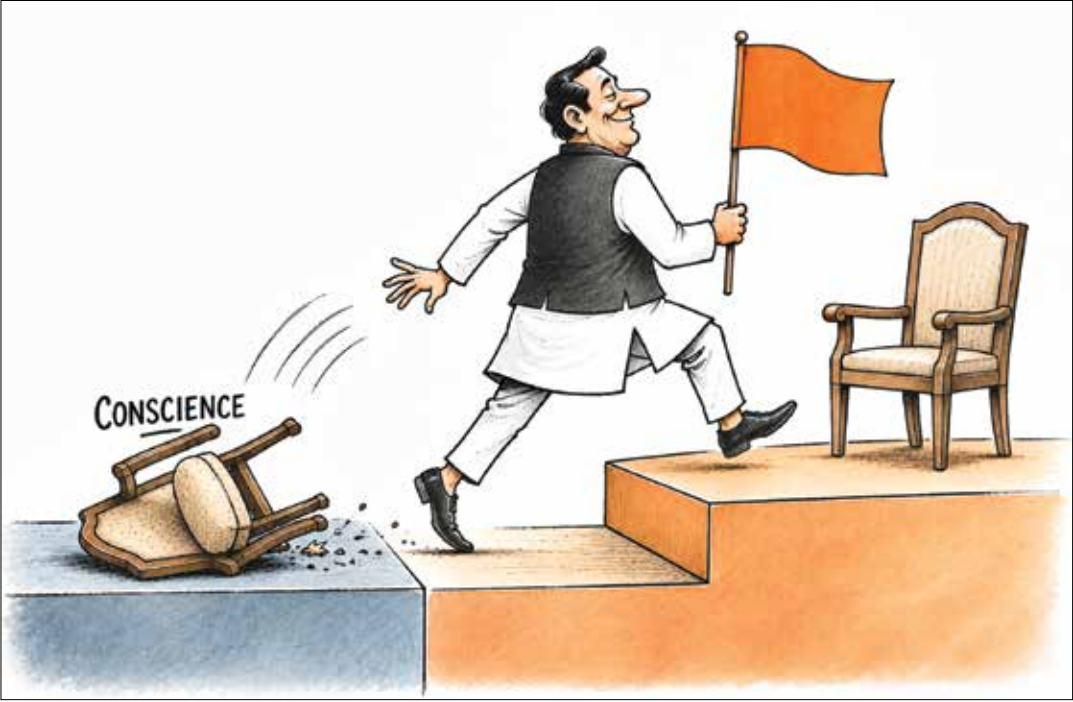


SLOKA ROY

THE WRITER IS A LAW STUDENT

In June, several developments were observed in relation to political defection in India, which can make a great case for academic research for political scientists in the future. In West Bengal, 19 rebel Trinamool Congress Lok Sabha MPs, led by former party chief whip Kakoli Ghosh Dastidar and veteran parliamentarian Sudip Bandyopadhyay, walked into Lok Sabha Speaker Om Birla's office on June 14 and announced their merger with the Nationalist Citizens Party of India, a registered but little-known outfit from Tripura with no meaningful presence in national politics. In Maharashtra, six of Shiv Sena (Uddhav Thackeray)'s nine Lok Sabha MPs skipped a "three-line party whip" meeting on June 18 and submitted a letter to the Speaker seeking a merger with Eknath Shinde's Shiv Sena, with a formal announcement expected by June 20. Two parties, two States, one template.

The Anti-Defection Law, contained in the Tenth Schedule of the Indian Constitution, was



Defection loopholes continue to undermine India's democratic mandate

enacted with the intention of tackling the problem of constant political defections within India. The law, however, was passed in haste, rushed through the two Houses, and lacked any national consensus. It left some major vacuums, which allowed the judiciary to tweak the law to suit varying societal temperaments. Paragraph (6) of the Schedule grants wide powers to the Chairman or the Speaker of a House to decide questions of disqualification on grounds of defection, without prescribing any deadline for a decision. Judicial interpretation has vested the Speaker with sole and supreme authority to decide the question of disqualification. Beginning in 1992 with the majority opinion in Kihoto Hollohon v. Zachilhu and Ors. (1992), which also made the Speaker's decision amenable to judicial

A MORALITY-BASED REASONING THAT LEADS TOWARDS THE RULING DISPENSATION IS NOT MORALITY

review, his authority has been reaffirmed in Ravi S. Naik v. UOI (1994), Rajendra Singh Rana v. Swami Prasad Maurya (2007) and Subhash Desai v. Principal Secretary (2023).

These things lead to two problems: first, the vague 'merger' exemption coupled with the finality of the Speaker's decision; and second, the absence of a deadline for the Chairman/Speaker to

decide on disqualification petitions. The text of the Schedule is silent on how these two situations must be interpreted, leaving space for judicial interpretation, which has widened, rather than bridged, the vacuum between the law's letter and its actual impact.

The solutions to these problems are not unknown. The Law Commission's 170th Report of 1999 explicitly recommended transferring adjudicatory authority from the Speaker to an independent tribunal, which had been recommended by the Dinesh Goswami Committee nearly a decade earlier, in 1990, and was reaffirmed by the National Commission to Review the Working of the Constitution in 2002. None of it became law. An independent constitutional tribunal for defection cases, mandatory intra-party elections with public disclosure of party

finances, and a clear constitutional bar on defectors holding ministerial office for the remainder of their term are not radical proposals but some of the ideas that need to be implemented for our democracy to sustain and thrive and to protect it from external forces that are becoming a threat to it.

The reasoning of morality given by these opposition leaders after leaving their parties and defecting to the BJP also needs to be debunked. The AAP members who crossed over to the BJP in April 2026, the Trinamool MPs who just discovered their conscience recently following their previous party's election defeat, and the Congress legislators who discovered theirs in Madhya Pradesh in 2020 all invoked an inability to remain within parties "touched by corruption". If the grievance is genuine criminality, the prescribed remedy in a constitutional democracy is the courts, the electorate, or a competing political platform. A morality-based reasoning that leads towards the ruling dispensation is not morality. It is just them being opportunistic to make sure they accrue all the benefits one gets from being cosy with the establishment.

India first confronted this problem in 1967, when Gaya Lal, an MLA from Hassanpur in Haryana, switched parties three times within a fortnight, twice within a nine-hour span, and gave rise to the political phrase "Aaya Ram, Gaya Ram" (Ram came, Ram went). Parliament's institutional response, 18 years later, was the Tenth Schedule. The law was meant to end the game. Instead, several tricks, in the form of loopholes, were found in this game of political defection. The electorate deserves a legislature that finally addresses these loopholes.

Views expressed are personal

Scrutinising Tonbo's Defence Story

Chinese suppliers and Singapore links complicate Tonbo's indigenous defence claims

STRATEGIC FRONTIERS



ADVIKA DWIVEDI

THE WRITER IS PURSUING MASTER'S DEGREE IN BUSINESS LAW

For the better part of a decade, India has sought to reduce its dependence on foreign suppliers for defence equipment and build a domestic industry capable of designing, manufacturing and exporting sophisticated military technology. At first glance, this Bengaluru-based company is an almost ideal expression of that new defence economy. Tonbo Imaging designs and manufactures electro-optical and infrared systems, thermal imaging equipment, weapon sights, targeting systems, missile seekers and other sophisticated sensing and guidance technologies. It has built an international customer base, with its products being deployed in 24 countries, and positioned itself squarely within the country's push for Atmanirbharta, or self-reliance. On the surface, it is precisely the kind of company that India has been trying to create – home-grown, technology-driven and increasingly global.

But there is another story buried beneath that one. It concerns where some of the components inside those systems come from, the role of a Singapore-based shareholder in Tonbo's commercial affairs and allegations disclosed in the company's draft prospectus concerning Chinese suppliers.

The consequential question is whether an Indian defence company can be considered genuinely indigenous when critical parts of its technology supply chain remain abroad and, in some cases, appear to run through China.

Trade-data platform Volza records more than 11,500 import shipments into Tonbo Imaging India from 226 suppliers. About 2,262 of those shipments, or roughly 19.65%, are attributed to China, while around 1,157 are associated with Singapore. This implies that China is a significant country of origin in Tonbo India's recorded activity. The identity of some of the suppliers matters too. Trade records identify Chinese optics companies, including Changchun Jstar Optics Co. Ltd. and Changchun Sunday Optoelectronics Co. Ltd., among Tonbo's trading relationships. That makes a closer examination of what Tonbo is importing and, more importantly, which components are coming from China hard to avoid.

For a company whose business is built around electro-optics and thermal imaging, such details are not incidental; rather, they can be among the most consequential components in the architecture of a modern military system. It is important to know which components originate in China. And, perhaps most importantly, does the company's public description of its indigenous capabilities give investors an adequate understanding of those dependencies?



Investors should understand what lies inside Tonbo before investing

'INDIGENOUS' IS NOT A BINARY CONDITION

Further, the ownership structure makes these questions more interesting. According to Tonbo's IPO documents, CEAQ Technologies Pte. Ltd., a Singapore company formerly known as Tonbo Imaging Pte. Ltd., held 26.77% of the company before the proposed offering. CEAQ Technologies Private Limited, the Indian group entity formerly known as Tonbo Imaging Private Limited, held another 17.74%.

Together, the two CEAQ entities represented more than 44% of Tonbo before the IPO. Tonbo's financial records also involve CEAQ in related-party transactions, which include the purchase of project material and equipment. The records do establish enough of the surrounding architecture to make the question legitimate – Tonbo imports from China; Chinese optics manufacturers appear among its trading relationships; CEAQ Singapore has commercial

dealings with Tonbo; and CEAQ Singapore is also a substantial shareholder. The company's revised draft prospectus makes that scrutiny more pertinent. It discloses allegations concerning the procurement of critical components from Chinese original equipment manufacturers through CEAQ Technologies Pte. Ltd., alongside other allegations concerning the economics of certain contracts and the presentation of the company's order book. Tonbo has denied the allegations.

Also, the company's recent financial performance is considerably less exuberant than the broader defence indigenisation story. Revenue from operations rose to ₹469.08 crore in FY25 from ₹428.19 crore in FY24. In FY26, however, it fell to ₹362.65 crore. Profit after tax declined from ₹72.76 crore to ₹50.88 crore, while EBITDA fell from ₹139.06 crore to ₹104.62 crore.

In other words, revenue declined by roughly 23% and profit by about 30%. But it does mean that investors should ask more sophisticated questions than those concerning the size of Tonbo's order book. And this

is particularly relevant when Tonbo is approaching the market with an offer that will not provide the company with fresh equity capital. The proposed issue is entirely an offer for sale comprising up to 18.09 million shares. Existing shareholders, including the two CEAQ entities, are among those selling shares. The public market is being asked to place a value on a business that existing shareholders are, in part, choosing to monetise. That makes the quality of the underlying business and the transparency of its economics all the more important.

India has been remarkably successful at changing the rhetoric around defence manufacturing. The country now speaks confidently about indigenous design, domestic production and defence exports. But "indigenous" is not a binary condition. India's strategic concern with China is that dependence on a geopolitical rival for critical technologies can become a vulnerability when circumstances change.

That is why the Ministry of Defence should be asking questions that are different from those of stock market investors. The government should want to know whether its supply is secure. That is why the most important questions surrounding the IPO may not be how large India's defence market will become, how much the company can grow or even at what valuation investors are willing to invest. It is, in fact, a more basic question: when India says it is building an indigenous defence industry, what, precisely, does "indigenous" mean? A public offering provides an unusually useful place to begin answering it. Because before investors decide what Tonbo is worth, they should first understand what is inside it.

Views expressed are personal

To Counsel and to Listen

Mandodari’s warnings to Ravana reveal why true loyalty demands honest disagreement, especially when pride begins overpowering evidence, restraint and sound judgement

BHARAT
KI SOCH



ANIL RAJPUT

THE WRITER IS CHAIRPERSON,
BHARAT KI SOCH

Not every failure begins with ignorance. Sometimes the danger is visible, the warnings are spoken and the consequences are foreseeable. Yet a decision continues because confidence has hardened into certainty and desire has become stronger than judgement. As Ravana’s queen, Mandodari stood close enough to greatness to recognise his extraordinary capability, yet close enough to his flaws to see where they could lead. Her story asks a question that is deeply personal and strikingly relevant to modern organisations: what does loyalty require when someone we respect is making a decision we believe is wrong?

Mandodari is remembered for wisdom, dignity and fidelity, but what makes her especially compelling is that her affection for Ravana never completely clouds her judgement. Mandodari could recognise all of Ravana’s strengths without pretending that achievement excused error. In the Yudha Kanda, while grieving after his death, she reflects that Ravana had once conquered his senses, only to be conquered by those very senses. She also recalls warning him against hostility with Rama and points to signs that should have forced reconsideration, including Khara’s defeat and Hanuman’s entry into Lanka. Her grief carries a hard truth. Ravana’s fall did not come from lack of ability. It came when ability ceased to be governed by restraint.

Her relationship with Ravana also challenges a common misunderstanding of loyalty. To care for someone is not to agree with every choice they make. Respect for a senior colleague should not prevent someone from questioning a decision that may expose a team or organisation to unnecessary risk. The most valuable people around a leader are often those committed enough to protect the larger purpose, even when doing so requires respectful disagreement. Loyalty does not require the surrender of professional judgement.

Ravana’s tragedy also shows that receiving advice and truly being open to advice are very different things. He hears counsel from Mandodari, Vibhishana and others, yet confidence in his own strength repeatedly outweighs contrary judgement. A meeting may contain experienced people, but that means little if everyone waits to hear the senior-most person’s opinion before deciding what they are willing to say. Such a room may appear harmonious while quietly depriving the organisation of independent judgement. Strong leaders need colleagues who are willing to disagree with them. When difficult questions are dismissed or treated as negativity, people quickly learn that silence is safer. A leader’s reaction to disagreement influences how much



Ravana’s downfall shows how great capability turns dangerous when leaders stop listening

COMPETENCE MAY
EARN AUTHORITY,
BUT CHARACTER
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truth will reach them the next time something goes wrong.

The consequences of Ravana’s choices reveal how quickly a personal impulse can grow beyond the individual. His desire for Sita is personal, yet the consequences eventually engulf his family, his warriors and Lanka itself. In professional life, personal equations can similarly distort decisions that should remain objective. A disagreement can influence who is trusted with responsibility. Familiarity can become favouritism. Constructive criticism can be interpreted as disloyalty. Wounded pride can keep an unnecessary dispute alive. Personal impulses must never be allowed to become organisational decisions. The higher the responsibility, the more carefully emotion must be separated from judgement.

This makes Mandodari’s reflection on Ravana’s senses especially significant. Ravana was not undone because he lacked intelligence or capability. The tragedy lies in the fact that the man who had mastered so much around him could no longer master what was within him. Intelligence, ambition and

achievement become unstable when unsupported by emotional discipline. Someone who reacts angrily whenever difficult news is brought forward may gradually create a culture in which problems are concealed rather than addressed. A person who cannot accept criticism may surround themselves with agreement instead of insight. Achievement cannot compensate indefinitely for a failure of self-mastery. Competence may earn authority, but character determines how safely that authority is exercised.

The warnings surrounding Ravana were also not hidden. Khara had been defeated. Hanuman had entered Lanka despite its formidable defences. Rama and his allies had demonstrated capabilities that should have forced a reconsideration of earlier assumptions. Yet confidence continued to overpower evidence. Organisations can fall into the same pattern. Repeated concerns within a team, unusual departures, missed commitments, recurring client dissatisfaction or a growing reluctance among colleagues to speak candidly may each appear manageable in isolation. Taken together, they may signal that something deeper requires attention. Good leadership recognises warning signs before they become crises. Experience should make leaders more alert to changing realities, not more certain that past success guarantees future outcomes.

Recognising that a decision is failing creates another challenge: the willingness to reverse it. Ravana had opportunities to reconsider, return Sita and prevent further destruction, but retreat had become intertwined with pride. Similar pressures appear in corporate life in quieter ways. A leader may have backed an initia-

tive that is no longer working, committed to an unrealistic deadline or supported a strategy that circumstances have overtaken. Continuing because changing direction may appear to be an admission of error can turn a manageable mistake into a larger one. Changing course is not weakness when circumstances have changed. Correcting one’s own decision can strengthen credibility because it shows that the organisation’s interests matter more than defending personal judgement.

Mandodari’s position also speaks to those who work close to important decisions. Not everyone in a room possesses the authority to determine the final outcome, but proximity to a decision still carries responsibility. Those whose experience allows them to identify a serious risk should not assume that their duty ends with silent implementation. Mandodari could counsel Ravana, but she could not choose for him. We may not control another person’s decision, but we remain responsible for the honesty of the advice we give. Integrity sometimes lies not in controlling the outcome, but in ensuring that convenience, hierarchy or personal closeness has not compromised professional judgement.

Her story nevertheless leaves us with a harder question. At what point does counsel cease to be enough? Vibhishana ultimately leaves Ravana’s side, while Mandodari remains. It would be unfair to judge her circumstances through the expectations of a modern workplace or ignore the duties that shaped her position as Ravana’s wife. In professional life, repeated objection cannot become merely ceremonial. There may come a point when an issue must be taken beyond an informal conversation,

placed before a wider group or examined through an appropriate organisational process. Ethical courage is reflected not only in what we believe, but also in what we are prepared to do when a line should not be crossed.

This responsibility cannot rest entirely on the courage of one individual. Healthy organisations create ways for concerns to travel upward and difficult questions to be examined before consequences become severe. Reviews, independent scrutiny, open discussions and clearly understood processes for raising concerns are valuable because they improve judgement. Good organisations do not eliminate disagreement. They create disciplined ways of learning from it. A strong corporate culture is one in which raising a problem is not confused with creating a problem, and difficult information is treated as something to examine rather than suppress.

Perhaps Mandodari’s most profound lesson, however, is less corporate and more deeply human. She sees Ravana’s flaws clearly and still mourns him deeply. Her grief does not require her to rewrite his choices, and her judgement does not erase her affection. That is a form of moral maturity. In life, people we admire can disappoint us. Colleagues we respect can make poor decisions. Mentors can be wrong. Wisdom lies in resisting two easy extremes: blind loyalty and total condemnation. We can recognise someone’s abilities while questioning their actions. We can care without becoming uncritical. We can disagree without losing dignity.

Mandodari’s story therefore leaves leaders with one responsibility and those around them with another. Leaders must create conditions in which truth can reach them, particularly when it is inconvenient. Those they trust must have the courage to offer that truth without allowing loyalty to become silence. Organisations must ensure that independent judgement does not disappear the moment a senior voice has expressed a preference. And each of us must cultivate the self-mastery to hear what challenges our confidence before circumstances force us to hear it.

Ravana possessed power, knowledge and extraordinary capability, yet Mandodari saw that none of them could protect a person who stopped governing himself and stopped listening to those who wished him well. That may be the lasting wisdom of her story. The people who truly stand beside us are not those who make every choice easier to defend, but those who help us recognise when a choice should change. In leadership as in life, what greater loyalty can there be than the courage to tell someone the truth before consequences do it for us?

Views expressed are personal

The ‘Golden Door’ is Closing Fast

Trump’s immigration crackdown now threatens legal migrants, asylum seekers and America itself; writes Ritik Kumar

For decades, the United States sold itself to the world through a powerful promise: regardless of birthplace, people willing to work, study and contribute could find opportunity in America. Donald Trump’s second presidency is replacing that promise with something narrower – an immigration system increasingly organised around suspicion, wealth and exclusion.

The latest measures show how far the crackdown has travelled beyond undocumented migration. The administration has disrupted immigrant visa processing as consular officials are trained under tougher “public charge” standards, while preparing to revoke business and tourist visas of potentially 200,000 foreigners who subsequently sought asylum. The message is increasingly difficult to misunderstand: entering America legally no longer guar-

antees that Washington will treat an immigrant as welcome.

Legal migration targeted

This exposes the contradiction at the heart of Trump’s immigration politics. The administration repeatedly insists that its objection is to illegal immigration. Yet spouses, parents and children seeking lawful family reunification now face greater uncertainty. Applicants following established procedures are being subjected to an immigration philosophy increasingly concerned with whether newcomers might someday require government assistance.

That transforms immigration from a question of legality into one of economic worthiness. America is moving towards a system where wealth provides reassurance while vulnerability generates suspicion.

Governments have every right to screen immigrants and prevent fraud. But legiti-

THE CRACKDOWN HAS
TRAVELLED BEYOND
ILLEGAL MIGRATION

mate enforcement becomes something different when entire categories of applicants are treated as potential liabilities before entering the country.

Asylum under assault

The proposed mass cancellation of B1 and B2 visas takes this philosophy further. Seeking asylum is itself a legal process. Whether a claim ultimately succeeds is another matter, but applying for protection cannot automatically be equated with deception.

Cancelling visas rendered practically irrelevant by pending asylum applications appears less an enforcement necessity than political theatre. Its purpose is deterrence: demonstrating that Washington can impose consequences even on migrants who entered through authorised channels.

Trump has repeatedly portrayed asylum as a loophole exploited by foreigners. Such sweeping suspicion blurs the distinction between combating fraudulent applications and undermining asylum itself – a protection created precisely because genuine persecution cannot always be anticipated before somebody begins a journey.

America diminishes itself

The greater damage may ultimately be inflicted on America. Its universities, laboratories, technology companies and businesses became globally dominant partly because the country attracted ambitious

people from everywhere. Immigration was not charity; it became one of America’s greatest competitive advantages.

Trump risks converting that advantage into self-inflicted isolation. Skilled workers can choose other economies, entrepreneurs can build companies elsewhere and students can select universities where immigration rules are less politically volatile.

A superpower does not demonstrate strength by making families fear consular appointments or treating foreigners principally as potential burdens. America became powerful because people wanted to enter, contribute and belong. Trump appears determined to make that aspiration harder. Closing America’s doors may satisfy his political base; it could also leave the country behind those doors poorer, smaller and considerably less attractive to the world.

Views expressed are personal

CM URGES PROTESTERS NOT TO CALL BANDHS

Manipur: Violence reported along IT Road, houses set ablaze in Kangpokpi

MPOST BUREAU
Imphal, September 1

Fresh violence was reported along the remote IT Road in Manipur's Kangpokpi district early Tuesday, with firing and arson incidents allegedly targeting villages inhabited by the Liangmei Naga community.

According to the Makui Village Authority, a group of armed men allegedly attacked Pipuram Naga Village around 4 am and opened fire before setting several houses on fire. The authority claimed that houses, food grains, household articles and other belongings were destroyed in the incident.

The attackers allegedly proceeded towards the main Makui Naga Village, where firing continued, the village authority said in a statement issued on Tuesday.

At least one person was reportedly injured in the violence. A road blockade and exchange of gunfire were also reported in the area during the early morning hours.

The Makui Village Authority condemned what it described as an attack by Kuki militants on Pipuram and Makui villages. It alleged that the attackers attempted to torch houses in the main Makui village with the intention of causing large-scale casualties.



Police personnel douse a fire at Sagolband area during a 24-hour general strike in Imphal West, Manipur, Tuesday

PTI

HIGHLIGHTS

- » According to the Makui Village Authority, a group of armed men allegedly attacked Pipuram Naga Village around 4 am and opened fire before setting several houses on fire
- » The authority claimed that houses, food grains, household articles and other belongings were destroyed in the incident
- » The attackers allegedly proceeded towards the main Makui Naga Village, where firing continued, the village authority said

The authority also referred to an earlier incident on August 27, claiming that four Makui villagers were killed in what it described as a pre-planned ambush between Makui Ashang Village and

Thanambam Village. It said the latest incident, coming shortly after the alleged killings, had intensified apprehension among residents living along the IT Road. The village authority

alleged that the repeated attacks were aimed at forcing Liangmei Naga residents to leave the area and taking control of what it described as their ancestral land.

The allegations could not be independently verified.

The IT Road cuts through a remote and sparsely populated region of Manipur, where Kuki, Naga and Nepali communities live in scattered settlements across the hilly terrain.

The area has witnessed periodic tensions, road blockades and armed clashes involving Kuki

and Naga villages. The latest violence has again raised concerns over the safety of communities residing along the route.

Further information on the extent of damage, the number of casualties and the condition of the injured person was awaited.

Manipur CM urges protesters not to call bandhs

Meanwhile, a general strike called by an organisation demanding implementation of NRC affected normal life in Manipur on Tuesday, as Chief Minister Y Khemchand Singh urged people to refrain from calling bandhs and choose other forms of agitation.

The 24-hour general strike was called by Campaign for Just and Fair Delimitation (JFD) to press for the demand for implementation of NRC update before conducting the census, though the Centre on Monday deferred the exercise in the state.

Market establishments and business centres remained closed, and streets wore a deserted look.

Educational institutions also remained closed while public transport remained off the road in Imphal East, Imphal West, Thoubal, Bishnupur and Kakching districts, officials said.

Bihar to get NSD campus, CM hails Centre's nod

MPOST BUREAU
Patna, September 1

Bihar Chief Minister Samrat Choudhary on Monday thanked Prime Minister Narendra Modi and Union Culture Minister Gajendra Singh Shekhawat after the Centre approved the establishment of a new National School of Drama (NSD) campus in the state.

Choudhary said the initiative would give Bihar's rich theatre and performing arts traditions greater national recognition while creating new opportunities for young artists.

He said Bihar has a distinctive cultural heritage associated with personalities such as Kalidasa, Ramvriksha Benipuri and Bhikhari Thakur, besides a strong tradition of folk theatre.

The NSD campus, he said, would provide aspiring artists access to professional training in theatre, stagecraft and performing arts, as well as advanced research facilities. It would also reduce the need for artists to travel outside the state for specialised training and help integrate traditional folk theatre with contemporary practices.

The state has already established the Bihar Sangeet Natak Akademi to preserve and promote theatre and performing arts. Choudhary said the government would provide suitable land for the NSD campus and bear 50 per cent of the approved construction cost.

Ram Temple Trust set to get first CEO

Names shortlisted; key meet today

MPOST BUREAU
Ayodhya, September 1

The selection committee is likely to submit three short-listed names to the Shri Ram Janmabhoomi Teerth Kshetra Trust for the first CEO of the Ram temple, sources said on Tuesday.

The first CEO of the Ram temple will be selected at a meeting to be held on Wednesday at the place of the president of the Ram Mandir Trust, Nriya Gopal Das, in Maniramdas Chhawani.

Selection committee officials, retired Justice Pramod Kohli, retired Lieutenant General Vishnukant Chaturvedi, and expert member Suresh Hawde, have reached Ayodhya.

Names for three posts (two members and general secretary) may be announced on Wednesday. Three vacant posts were created following the death of trust member Vimalendra Mohan Pratap Mishra, and alleged theft of offerings and the resignation of former general secretary of the temple trust Champat Rai and Anil Mishra.

The temple trust will also make an official announcement on the post of secretary of the trust in a meeting likely to begin at 2 pm on Wednesday.

Jagdish Aafle will be the first secretary of the temple trust.

Aafle, who is from Maharashtra, is associated with the Rashtriya Swayamsevak Sangh (RSS) and is the Ram temple construction project manager.

NAMES FOR THREE POSTS (TWO MEMBERS AND GENERAL SECRETARY) MAY BE ANNOUNCED ON WEDNESDAY

A resident of Pune, Aafle holds a B.Tech in Electrical Engineering and an M.Tech from IIT Bombay. He is said to have worked in India, Europe and the United States before returning to India after retirement.

According to the sources, Aafle joined the Ram Mandir construction project as an honorary project manager on the RSS' recommendation.

He has since been living with his wife at the Shri Ram Janmabhoomi Teerth Kshetra premises in Ayodhya.

VHP international general secretary Bajrang Lal Bangda may also be included in the trust, sources said.

Treasurer of the temple trust Govind Dev Giri, upon being asked whether the new CEO will be named on Wednesday, said, "That is up to the trust to decide. I expect it to happen, but the Board of Trustees will decide whether to do it or not."

"We sought this guidance (from a three-member selection panel) because we were in search of an excellent CEO to ensure the superior management of such a big, world-renowned temple," Giri said, adding that the panel went through approximately 5,500 applications.

Briefs

Anna Hazare hospitalised

MUMBAI: Social activist Anna Hazare has been admitted to Bombay Hospital here after his blood reports suggested a renal infection, his associate said on Tuesday. Consultant physician Dr Gautam Bhansali said that Hazare is stable and recovering. Hazare, 89, was brought to Bombay Hospital in south Mumbai on Monday night from his native Ralegan Siddhi village in Ahilyanagar district.

Assam: 3 die in landslide

GUWAHATI: A couple and their daughter died, while their son was injured in a landslide in Assam's Guwahati on Tuesday. The incident occurred in the Mathgharia area of the city when they were sleeping in their house. The couple's son was rescued from beneath the debris. Incessant rain since early Tuesday is suspected to have triggered the landslide.

CISF to guard ISRO's Raigad facility

RAIGAD: CISF on Tuesday assumed security responsibility for ISRO's Propellant Complex at Rasayani in Maharashtra's Raigad district. The facility, part of Satish Dhawan Space Centre, stores oxidiser used for PSLV, GSLV and LVM3 missions. The induction makes it the 32nd crucial installation in Maharashtra under CISF protection.

L-G Saxena flags off 'Ladakh Bike Week'



MPOST BUREAU
Leh, September 1

Lieutenant Governor Vinai Kumar Saxena on Tuesday flagged off the inaugural edition of 'Ladakh Bike Week 2026' to showcase Ladakh's growing stature as a premier motorcycling and high-altitude adventure tourism destination.

Ladakh Bike Week 2026 is one of the eight flagship UT-level tourism festivals identified for destination promotion, visitor engagement and diversification of tourism across the region.

Interacting with the bikers, the Lt Governor emphasised that the growth of adventure tourism must remain responsible, safe

and environmentally sustainable, ensuring that the increasing popularity of Ladakh translates into meaningful opportunities for local youth, entrepreneurs and communities while protecting the region's fragile Himalayan environment.

Ladakh's dramatic mountains, rugged terrain and some of the highest motorable passes in the world have made the region a sought-after destination for motorcycle enthusiasts from across India and abroad.

Bike Week seeks to build on this growing popularity and position Ladakh not merely as a place bikers travel through, but as a destination they choose for adventure and exploration.

Cong, Akali Dal 'hollowed out' Punjab: Mann

MPOST BUREAU
Mohali, September 1

Punjab Chief Minister Bhagwant Singh Mann on Tuesday criticised the Congress and Akali Dal, accusing them of having "hollowed out Punjab like termites" and alleging that the Akali Dal is "seeking an alliance with the BJP to loot the state".

Addressing a Lok Milni programme in Kharar, Mann said Opposition parties were focused on political power while his government was working on education, healthcare, roads, electricity and water.

He warned that a change in government could affect welfare schemes launched by the AAP government.

Mann highlighted free power, jobs for more than 70,000 youth, improved roads and healthcare initiatives, including the Mukh Mantri Sehat Yojna.

Hry Assembly Monsoon Session ends amid uproar; 11 Bills passed

MPOST BUREAU
Chandigarh, September 1

The three-day Monsoon Session of the Haryana Vidhan Sabha concluded on Tuesday with 11 Bills being passed, while Chief Minister Nayab Singh Saini criticised the Opposition over its conduct during protests on the opening day.

Addressing a press conference after the session, Saini said the House held three sittings with nearly 16 hours of meaningful discussion. He alleged that Congress MLAs had violated the dignity of the House by protesting at the Assembly gate and later inside the premises. He also accused some legislators of manhandling security personnel, saying Leader of Opposition Bhupinder Singh Hooda, being a former chief minister and senior political leader, was expected to exercise restraint and maintain decorum.

Three Calling Attention Motions concerning



Haryana CM Nayab Saini addresses the media persons at Vidhan Sabha

law and order, the Haryana Kaushal Rozgar Nigam (HKRNL) and contractual teachers in universities were also discussed. Saini defended HKRNL, saying it had replaced the system of contractors and middlemen with a more transparent and accountable mechanism. He said employees under the system were entitled to 10 medical and 10 casual leaves annually, while women employees received 22 days of casual leave.

The Assembly passed a resolution supporting the nationwide 'Guru Ravidas Maharaj Samrasta Sankalp Abhiyan' marking the 650th Prakash Parv of Sant Shiromani Guru Ravidas Ji. Saini said the Samrasta Yatra from Dera Sachkhand Ballan in Jalandhar to Varanasi would enter Haryana on October 5, with reception points and public meetings planned along its route.

Among the 11 Bills passed were the Haryana Appropriation (No. 3) Bill, 2026, authorising Rs 7,136.63 crore from the Consolidated Fund for 2026-27; the Haryana State Commission for Minorities Bill, 2026; Haryana Local Audit Bill, 2026; Haryana Private Universities (Amendment) Bill, 2026; Haryana State Commission for Women (Amendment) Bill, 2026; Haryana GST (Amendment) Bill, 2026; Haryana Panchayati Raj (Amendment) Bill, 2026; and the Haryana Right to Business Bill, 2026.

UP: Rs 17 cr in fake currency found in PNB currency chest

BISWAJEET BANERJEE
Saharanpur, September 1

The recovery of counterfeit currency, having a face value of nearly Rs 17 crore, from the Punjab National Bank (PNB) currency chest in Saharanpur has raised questions over the bank's cash-handling and security systems.

Preliminary investigation suggests fake notes may have been deposited in the secured currency chest, allegedly allowing genuine currency to be withdrawn in exchange.

PNB has suspended three officials following an internal inquiry. They are Ravi Kumar Kansa, senior manager at the divisional office; Sushil Sharma, manager of the currency chest; and Amit Kumar, manager of the PNB chest at Khera Bazar in Yamunanagar. PNB nodal officer Arun Kumar Chaubey lodged an FIR against them at Kotwali Sadar Bazar police station.

A part-time housekeeper, Vishal Kumar, who was assigned to arrange currency bundles, has also been removed. CCTV footage reportedly shows him handling notes from the bundles.

Initially, 148 bundles containing 1,000 fake Rs 500 notes each, valued at Rs 7.40 crore, were recovered. Further scrutiny of cash and records subsequently raised the estimated value of counterfeit currency to nearly Rs 17 crore.

Police have formed a Special Investigation Team, while a PNB headquarters team is examining records and transactions. DIG Abhishek Singh, District Magistrate Arvind Kumar Chauhan and SSP Abhinandan Singh inspected the currency chest at Sophia Market on Monday.

SHAKTI SHARMA SCRIPTS HISTORY

IAF gets 1st woman non-medical officer to attain AVM rank

OUR CORRESPONDENT
New Delhi, September 1

Indian Air Force woman officer Shakti Sharma is recorded as the first woman officer from the non-medical stream in the Indian Defence Forces to attain the rank of Air Vice Marshal, marking a significant milestone in the continuing transformation of the armed forces. The Indian Air Force, on Monday, announced the significant development.

AVM Sharma assumed charge as Assistant Chief of the Air Staff (Education) at Air Headquarters on the very day, taking on a key responsibility in the Indian



Air Force's education and institutional development framework.

Commissioned into the Education Branch of the Indian Air Force on June 18, 1994, AVM Sharma brings more than three decades of distinguished service and extensive experience across a wide range of assignments. Her career has included

KEY POINTS

- » AVM Sharma assumed charge as Assistant Chief of the Air Staff (Education) at Air Headquarters
- » Air Vice Marshal Sharma has played a significant role in strengthening the IAF's engagement with leading academic institutions

postings at training establishments, field stations, command headquarters and Air Headquarters, giving her a broad understanding of the operational, training and institutional dimensions of the force.

Air Vice Marshal Sharma has played a significant role in strengthening the IAF's engagement with lead-

ing academic institutions. Among her notable initiatives were the establishment of IAF Chairs of Excellence at IIT Kanpur and Pune University, aimed at fostering academic collaboration, research and strategic defence engagement.

AVM Sharma also scripted another first during her career when she became

the first woman officer from the Tri-Services to command a Sainik School. As Principal of Sainik School, Kapurthala, she led an institution that plays an important role in preparing young students for careers in the armed forces and public service.

Her elevation to the rank of Air Vice Marshal is being viewed as a defining moment in the journey of women officers in India's defence forces, reflecting the expanding opportunities and responsibilities available to women across traditionally male-dominated military roles.

With more than 30 years

of service behind her, AVM Shakti Sharma's career represents a combination of professional excellence, institutional leadership and a commitment to nurturing India's future military talent. Her historic elevation adds another significant chapter to the growing list of milestones achieved by women officers in the country's armed forces.

As she assumes her new responsibility at Air Headquarters, Indian Air Force says her journey stands as an inspiration for generations of women officers who aspire to rise through the ranks and serve the nation with distinction.

News at a glance

UK PM pledges ‘clear’ growth plan in 1st Parliament address

LONDON: Andy Burnham pledged a “clear, coherent and credible approach” to unleashing economic growth for the UK in his first statement to Parliament on Tuesday as British Prime Minister.

Burnham took questions from members of Parliament in the House of Commons as it reconvened after the summer recess. He highlighted his tour of all parts of the United Kingdom during that period, which he claimed has helped him deliver a “clear diagnosis of what has gone wrong” due to the Opposition Conservative policies.

Indian among 12 killed in Russian attacks: Zelenskyy

LONDON: An Indian national was among 12 people killed in the latest Russian attacks on Ukraine, President Volodymyr Zelenskyy said on Tuesday, as drones and ballistic missiles struck several cities in the eastern European nation, damaging residential buildings and civilian infrastructure.

Since Monday evening, guided aerial bomb and drone strikes have continued against Odesa city and the surrounding region, leaving thousands of families without electricity, Zelenskyy said in a social media post.

SpaceX to set up Turbine Blade Foundry in Texas

HOUSTON: Commercial space firm SpaceX is constructing a specialised in-house foundry to manufacture high-spec gas turbine blades and vanes, CEO Elon Musk confirmed.

Confirming the plans on social media platform X, Musk on Saturday noted that while SpaceX and Tesla are racing to scale solar panel production, natural gas remains necessary to bridge power demands for several years. The strategic expansion targets a severe supply chain bottleneck that has stalled power generation.



King Haakon VIII.,(left), takes the oath according to the Constitution in the Storting, Norway’s parliament, accompanied by Crown Princess Ingrid Alexandra in Oslo on Tuesday

AP/PTI

Briefs

Schools reopen across Cuba

LAS MINAS: The Barroso family rose at dawn and hitched a cart to a borrowed horse to take one of their daughters to school on Tuesday, the first day of classes for many students across Cuba.

As the crises deepen on the island, thieves recently stole the family’s horse and killed it for food, so the Barrosos now rely on a borrowed animal for transportation, because school buses aren’t running.

21 terrorists killed in Balochistan

ISLAMABAD: At least 21 terrorists have been killed in two separate clashes between security forces and rebels in Pakistan’s restive Balochistan province, the Pakistan army said on Tuesday.

The incidents took place on Monday night in Nokcha, during which five security personnel and one Customs official were also killed, the army said in a statement.

SCO GROUPING CURRENTLY ENCOMPASSES 10 NATIONS

China’s Prez Xi urges SCO member states to make security key priority

PRESS TRUST OF INDIA
Bishkek, September1

Chinese President Xi Jinping on Tuesday called on the members of the Shanghai Cooperation Organisation (SCO) to make security a key priority and crack down on terrorism, separatism and extremism, transnational organised crimes, drug trafficking and telecom fraud.

“We should stay committed to taking security as a key goal, and foster an environment of common security. We should pursue coordinated measures to tackle traditional and non-traditional security threats,” Xi said while addressing the SCO summit in the Kyrgyz capital attended by Prime Minister Narendra Modi, Russian



China’s President Xi Jinping attends the Shanghai Cooperation Organization (SCO) summit, in Bishkek on Tuesday

AP/PTI

President Vladimir Putin and others.

“We should crack down on the three forces of terrorism, separatism and extremism, transnational organised crime, drug trafficking, and telecom

fraud,” he added.

Xi also spoke about the need for multilateral partnership for nuclear safety and security. “We believe in a sensible, coordinated, and balanced approach to nuclear security, and sup-

At SCO, Sharif says water must never be weaponised

PRESS TRUST OF INDIA
Islamabad, September1

Pakistan Prime Minister Shehbaz Sharif on Tuesday said that water was the “life-blood” of the region and it must never be weaponised.

Addressing the Shanghai Cooperation Organisation (SCO) Sum-

mit in the Kyrgyz capital, Sharif also said that the region cannot “realise its full potential without lasting peace,” Dawn reported.

“Water is the life-blood of our region. It sustains millions of lives, nourishes our land and secures the very future of our coming generations,” he said.

port a stronger multilateral partnership for nuclear safety and security,” he said. The SCO member states should strengthen cooperation on information security, bio-security, and outer space security,

Xi said. In a veiled criticism of the US, he said, “We must prevent external forces from interfering in our internal affairs, endangering our political security, and undermining regional stability.”

Iran would return to ceasefire pact if US does: Iran Prez

ASSOCIATED PRESS
Cairo, September1

Iran’s president said Tuesday his country is ready to return to the ceasefire deal reached with

the United States in June if Washington does the same, in conciliatory remarks following the first exchange of fire between the two countries in a month.

Speaking on the sidelines of the Shanghai Cooperation Organisation summit in Kyrgyzstan, Iran’s President Masoud Pezeshkian said that “if the US returns

to its commitments in the memorandum of understanding, the Islamic Republic of Iran will immediately reciprocate,” Iranian state media reported.

The June memorandum of understanding called for an immediate ceasefire and started a 60-day period for negotiations aimed at reaching a wider peace deal.

Nepal seeks climate compensation for flood

‘It is moral liability, not charity’



Children play along a street amid the ongoing flood rescue operations, in Rasuwa on Tuesday

PTI

PRESS TRUST OF INDIA
Kathmandu, September1

Nepal has launched a diplomatic push to seek climate-related compensation from greenhouse emitters for the devastation caused by the recent deadly flash floods, asserting that post-disaster assistance should be treated as a matter of “moral liability”, “not charity”.

Foreign Minister Shirsir Khanal said Nepal, despite contributing “virtually negligible” green-

house gas emissions, are bearing the disproportionate consequences of global warming, including rapid glacier melt and extreme mountain disasters.

“We are paying the ultimate price for a global crisis we did not create. The rapid melting of glaciers and these catastrophic mountain tsunamis are direct consequences of global climate change,” he said in an interview with Kantipur TV.

NORTH CENTRAL RAILWAY

L.No. : JHS-ELG-W-T-09-25-26-RT-2

Date : 29/08/2026

E-TENDER NOTICE

For and on behalf of President of India, the Sr. Divisional Electrical Engineer (Gen) North Central Railway, Jhansi invites open tenders through online (E-Tendering) for the following work :-

Tender No. : JHS-ELG-W-T-09-25-26-RT-2

Description of work : Electrical/G Work For : Jhansi Division :- Construction of Intake well be Ken River and laying of pipe line and filter plant at Banda.

Tender value : Rs. : 1,27,17,188/- only

Bid Security : Rs. 2,54,400/- only

Completion period : 06 months

Closing date of tender : 22/09/2026 (upto 15:00 Hrs).

● Tenderer will submit the tender online upto 22/09/2026 (upto 15:00 Hrs.).

● Complete details & for submission of tenders can be seen in Indian Railway Website <http://www.i-reps.gov.in>.

2013/26 (AS)

www.ncr.indianrailways.gov.in

PROCLAMATION REQUIRING THE APPEARANCE OF A PERSON ACCUSED

See Section 82 Cr. P.C. / 84 BNSS

Whereas complaint has been made before me that accused person Manjeet Singh @ Lahri S/o Bhola Singh R/o H. No. 383, 12.5 Gaj, TC Camp Raghunagar, Delhi has Committed (or is suspected to have committed) the offence in case FIR No. 789/2024, U/s 25/54/59 Arms Act, P.S. Rajouri Garden, Delhi and it has been returned to a warrant of arrest thereupon issued that the said accused Manjeet Singh @ Lahri cannot be found and whereas it has been shown to my satisfaction that the said accused Manjeet Singh @ Lahri has absconded (or is concealing himself to avoid the service of the said warrant).

Proclamation is hereby made that the said accused Manjeet Singh @ Lahri of case FIR No. 789/2024, U/s 25/54/59 Arms Act, P.S. Rajouri Garden, Delhi is required to appear before this Court to answer the said complaint on or before 03.10.2026.

By Order

Sh. Shashank Nandan Bhatt

Judicial Magistrate First Class

Room No. 356, 3rd Floor

Tis Hazari Courts, Delhi

DP/1905/WD/2026 (Court Matter)

कार्यपालक अभियंता का कार्यालय

पथ निर्माण विभाग, पथ प्रमण्डल, चतरा।

ई० प्रोक्वोरमेंट नोटिस सं० –05/2026-27 (1st Call)

Short Tender Ref. No.: RCD/Chatra/595/2026-27 Date: 29.08.2026

1.	कार्य का नाम:	सिमरिया – टण्डवा पथ (MDR-72) के कि० मी० 0.00 से कि० मी० 26.85 (कुल लम्बाई– 26.85 कि० मी०) का राईडिंग क्वालिटी में सुधार (Improvement of Riding Quality) कार्य।
2.	प्राक्कलित राशि :	रु० 33,59,64,294=00 (रु० तीस करोड़ उनसठ लाख चौसठ हजार दो सौ बीसनवे रुपये)
3.	कार्य पूर्ण करने की अवधि :	06 (छ) माह
4.	निविदा प्राप्ति की अंतिम तिथि /समय	21.09.2026 12.00 बजे दोपहर तक
5.	प्री बिड मिटिंग : तिथि, समय एवं स्थान	18.09.2026 (12.00 बजे दोपहर तक) मुख्य अभियंता (रा०) का कार्यालय पथ निर्माण विभाग, इंजिनियरिंग हास्टल नं०- 2, धुर्वी, राँची।
6.	वेबसाईट पर निविदा प्रकाशन की तिथि :	07.09.2026 10.30 बजे पूर्वाह्न
7.	निविदा प्रकाशित करने वाले कार्यालय का नाम एवं पता :	कार्यपालक अभियंता का कार्यालय, पथ निर्माण विभाग, पथ प्रमण्डल, चतरा।
8.	निविदा खोलने की तिथि	24.09.2026
9.	ई० प्रोक्वोरमेंट पदाधिकारी का सम्पर्क संख्या :	06541-224540
10.	ई० प्रोक्वोरमेंट सेल का हेल्पलाइन संख्या :	0651-2401010

विस्तृत जानकारी के लिए वेबसाईट <http://jharkhandtenders.gov.in> देखें।

नोट : निविदा की राशि घट – बढ़ सकती है।

कार्यपालक अभियंता

प०नि०वि०, पथ प्रमण्डल, चतरा।

PR 388741 (Road) 26-27 (D)

NORTHERN RAILWAY

OPEN E-TENDER NOTICE

For and on behalf of President of India, Sr. Divisional Mechanical Engineer (Co-ordination), Northern Railway, Delhi Division invites sealed e-tender on 'SINGLE PACKET SYSTEM' for following work from experienced and capable tenderers.

1	e-Tender No.	NRDLIOMCNWAMCA142025
2	Name of work	Annual Maintenance and Operation Contract (AMOC) for Automatic Coach Washing Plant (ACWP) installed at ANVT, DEE, and DLT Complex & Rajdhani complex of NDLS in Delhi Division for a period of three (03) years.
3	Work Place	Delhi Division
4	Period of Work	36 Months
5	Advertised Value	Rs. 6,51,49,425.00/- (including GST)
6	Bid Security to be deposited	Rs. 4,75,800.00/-
7	Tender Document Cost	Nil
8	Date and Time of availability of e-Tender Document	From 31/08/2026 14:54 Hrs to 21/09/2026 15:00 Hrs.
9	Date and time of E-tender closing	21/09/2026 15:00 Hrs.
10	Date and time of E-tender box opening	On 21/09/2026 after 15:00 hrs. If the date of opening happens to be holiday the E-Tender shall be opened on the next working day.
11	Place for opening E-Tender	Mechanical Department, Divisional Railway Manager's Office, Northern Railway, State Entry Road, New Delhi-110055

Note: The complete particulars of the tender may be found in website www.i-reps.gov.in.

File No: NR-DLIOMCNW(AMCA)/14/2025-Computer No: 348750 Date. As signed

SERVING CUSTOMERS WITH A SMILE

3002/2026

KIND ATTENTION RAIL PASSENGERS!

JANMASHTAMI SPECIAL TRAINS

In order to clear extra rush of passengers on the occasion of Janmashtami, Railways have decided to run the following Special Trains as per schedule given below :-

04410/04409 Hazrat Nizamuddin Jn - Mathura Jn - Hazrat Nizamuddin Jn Un-reserved Special Train	06 Trips																							
<table><tr><td>Train No.: 04410</td><td>↓</td><td>STATIONS</td><td>↑</td><td>Train No.: 04409</td></tr><tr><td>ARR.</td><td>DEP.</td><td></td><td></td><td>ARR.</td><td>DEP.</td></tr><tr><td>----</td><td>10:30</td><td>Hazrat Nizamuddin Jn</td><td>16:45</td><td>----</td><td>----</td></tr><tr><td>13:05</td><td>----</td><td>Mathura Jn</td><td>----</td><td>13:35</td><td>----</td></tr></table>	Train No.: 04410	↓	STATIONS	↑	Train No.: 04409	ARR.	DEP.			ARR.	DEP.	----	10:30	Hazrat Nizamuddin Jn	16:45	----	----	13:05	----	Mathura Jn	----	13:35	----	
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DAYS OF RUN: 04410 Ex Hazrat Nizamuddin Jn and 04409 Ex Mathura Jn on 03.09.2026, 04.09.2026 & 05.09.2026.																								
STOPPAGES: Okhla, Tuglakabad, Faridabad, Faridabad New Town, Ballabgarh, Asaoti, Palwal, Rundhi, Sholaka, Banchari, Hodal, Kosi Kalan, Chata, Ajhai, Vrindaban Road & Bhuteshwar Stations.																								
ACCOMMODATION: General Class.																								

04412/04411 Hazrat Nizamuddin Jn - Mathura Jn - Hazrat Nizamuddin Jn Un-reserved Special Train	06 Trips																							
<table><tr><td>Train No.: 04412</td><td>↓</td><td>STATIONS</td><td>↑</td><td>Train No.: 04411</td></tr><tr><td>ARR.</td><td>DEP.</td><td></td><td></td><td>ARR.</td><td>DEP.</td></tr><tr><td>----</td><td>09:45</td><td>Hazrat Nizamuddin Jn</td><td>16:30</td><td>----</td><td>----</td></tr><tr><td>12:20</td><td>----</td><td>Mathura Jn</td><td>----</td><td>12:50</td><td>----</td></tr></table>	Train No.: 04412	↓	STATIONS	↑	Train No.: 04411	ARR.	DEP.			ARR.	DEP.	----	09:45	Hazrat Nizamuddin Jn	16:30	----	----	12:20	----	Mathura Jn	----	12:50	----	
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12:20	----	Mathura Jn	----	12:50	----																			
DAYS OF RUN: 04412 Ex Hazrat Nizamuddin Jn and 04411 Ex Mathura Jn on 03.09.2026, 04.09.2026 & 05.09.2026.																								
STOPPAGES: Okhla, Tuglakabad, Faridabad, Faridabad New Town, Ballabgarh, Asaoti, Palwal, Rundhi, Sholaka, Banchari, Hodal, Kosi Kalan, Chata, Ajhai, Vrindaban Road & Bhuteshwar Stations.																								
ACCOMMODATION: General Class.																								

04415/04416 Delhi Jn - Ringas Jn - Delhi Jn Un-reserved Special Train	06 Trips																							
<table><tr><td>Train No.: 04415</td><td>↓</td><td>STATIONS</td><td>↑</td><td>Train No.: 04416</td></tr><tr><td>ARR.</td><td>DEP.</td><td></td><td></td><td>ARR.</td><td>DEP.</td></tr><tr><td>----</td><td>18:50</td><td>Delhi Jn</td><td>07:00</td><td>----</td><td>----</td></tr><tr><td>00:40</td><td>----</td><td>Ringas Jn</td><td>----</td><td>02:00</td><td>----</td></tr></table>	Train No.: 04415	↓	STATIONS	↑	Train No.: 04416	ARR.	DEP.			ARR.	DEP.	----	18:50	Delhi Jn	07:00	----	----	00:40	----	Ringas Jn	----	02:00	----	
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DAYS OF RUN: 04415 Ex Delhi Jn on 03.09.26, 04.09.26 & 05.09.26 and 04416 Ex Ringas Jn on 04.09.26, 05.09.26 & 06.09.26																								
STOPPAGES: Delhi Sarai Rohilla, Delhi Cantt., Gurgaon, Pataudi Road, Rewari jn., Narnaul & Nim Ka Thana Stations.																								
ACCOMMODATION: General Class.																								

04413/04414 Delhi Jn - Haridwar Jn - Delhi Jn Un-reserved Special Train	06 Trips																							
<table><tr><td>Train No.: 04413</td><td>↓</td><td>STATIONS</td><td>↑</td><td>Train No.: 04414</td></tr><tr><td>ARR.</td><td>DEP.</td><td></td><td></td><td>ARR.</td><td>DEP.</td></tr><tr><td>----</td><td>23:00</td><td>Delhi Jn</td><td>22:00</td><td>----</td><td>----</td></tr><tr><td>04:55</td><td>----</td><td>Haridwar Jn</td><td>----</td><td>17:00</td><td>----</td></tr></table>	Train No.: 04413	↓	STATIONS	↑	Train No.: 04414	ARR.	DEP.			ARR.	DEP.	----	23:00	Delhi Jn	22:00	----	----	04:55	----	Haridwar Jn	----	17:00	----	
Train No.: 04413	↓	STATIONS	↑	Train No.: 04414																				
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04:55	----	Haridwar Jn	----	17:00	----																			
DAYS OF RUN: 04413 Ex Delhi Jn on 03.09.26, 04.09.26 & 05.09.26 and 04414 Ex Haridwar Jn on 04.09.26, 05.09.26 & 06.09.26																								
STOPPAGES: Ghaziabad Jn., Meerut City Jn., Muzaffarnagar, Deoband & Roorkee Stations.																								
ACCOMMODATION: General Class.																								

01941/01942 Agra Cantt. Jn - Palwal - Agra Cantt. MEMU Un-reserved Special Train

10 Trips

Train No.: 01941	↓	STATIONS	↑	Train No.: 01942	
ARR.	DEP.			ARR.	DEP.
----	06:30	Agra Cantt. Jn	13:00	----	----
09:45	----	Palwal	----	----	10:00

DAYS OF RUN: 01941 Ex Agra Cantt. Jn and 01942 Ex Palwal from 02.09.2026 to 06.09.2026.

STOPPAGES: Runkuta, Bad, Mathura Jn, Chata, Kosi Kalan & Hodal Stations.

ACCOMMODATION: General Class.

01943/01944 Agra Cantt. Jn - Hazrat Nizamuddin Jn - Agra Cantt. MEMU Un-reserved Special Train

10 Trips

Train No.: 01943	↓	STATIONS	↑	Train No.: 01944	
ARR.	DEP.			ARR.	DEP.
----	16:00	Agra Cantt. Jn	01:50	----	----
20:25	----	Hazrat Nizamuddin Jn	----	20:35	----

DAYS OF RUN: 01943 Ex Agra Cantt. Jn and 01944 Ex Hazrat Nizamuddin Jn from 02.09.2026 to 06.09.2026.

STOPPAGES: Runkuta, Bad, Mathura Jn, Chata, Kosi Kalan, Hodal & Palwal Stations.

ACCOMMODATION: General Class.

04446/04445 Delhi Jn - Varanasi Jn - Delhi Jn Special Express Train

04 Trips

Train No.: 04446	↓	STATIONS	↑	Train No.: 04445	
ARR.	DEP.			ARR.	DEP.
----	21:10	Delhi Jn	11:45	----	----
15:00	----	Varanasi Jn	----	20:15	----

DAYS OF RUN: 04446 Ex Delhi Jn on 03.09.2026 & 05.09.2026 and 04445 Ex Varanasi Jn on 04.09.2026 & 06.09.2026.

STOPPAGES: New Delhi, Ghaziabad, Hapur, Moradabad, Bareilly, Shahjahanpur Jn, HarDOI, Alamnagar, Lucknow, Ayodhya Cantt & Jaunpur Jn Stations.

ACCOMMODATION: 2 Tier AC, 3 Tier AC, Sleeper & General.

02416/02415 New Delhi - Subedarganj - New Delhi Superfast Special Express Train

06 Trips

Train No.: 02416	↓	STATIONS	↑	Train No.: 02415	
ARR.	DEP.			ARR.	DEP.
----	23:00	New Delhi	23:30	----	----
09:45	----	Subedarganj	----	12:10	----

DAYS OF RUN: 02416 Ex New Delhi on 03.09.26, 04.09.26 & 05.09.26 and 02415 Ex Subedarganj on 04.09.26, 05.09.26 & 06.09.26.

STOPPAGES: Ghaziabad jn., Aligarh jn., Tundla jn., Etawah Jn, Govindpuri & Fatehpur Stations.

ACCOMMODATION: 2 Tier AC, 3 Tier AC, Sleeper & General.

For any other information passengers are requested to contact RailMadad Helpline No. 139 or may visit Indian Railways website <https://enquiry.indianrail.gov.in> or NTES App.

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OUTPUT INDEX FELL TO ITS LOWEST LEVEL SINCE AUGUST 2021

India's manufacturing growth slips to 5-year low in Aug on slower demand

OUR CORRESPONDENT

New Delhi, September 1

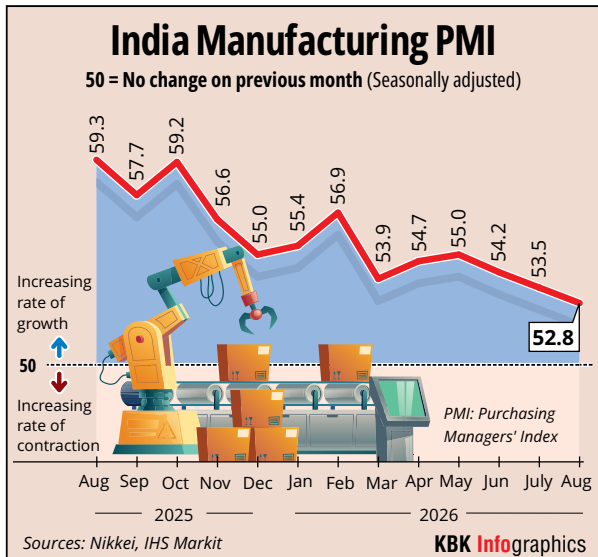
India's manufacturing sector growth slipped to five-year low of 52.8 in August as output and new orders moderated amid softer demand conditions, a monthly survey said on Tuesday.

The seasonally adjusted HSBC India Manufacturing Purchasing Managers' Index (PMI) declined from 53.5 in July to 52.8 in August, indicating the weakest improvement in the health of the sector for five years.

In the PMI parlance, a print above 50 means expansion, while a score below 50 denotes contraction.

The HSBC India Manufacturing Purchasing Managers' Index is a gauge of overall conditions derived from measures of new orders, output, employment, supplier delivery times and stocks of purchases.

Firms reported softer demand conditions, which subsequently led to weaker



HIGHLIGHTS

- » New orders continued to grow, though at their weakest pace in five years. Survey respondents linked the slower expansion to difficult market conditions
- » Meanwhile, export sales continued to climb, driven by demand from key markets such as Australia, Germany, mainland China, Spain, Thailand, and the US
- » Manufacturing employment fell for the first time in two-and-a-half years, though the rate of decline was only fractional

increases in buying levels and stocks, as well as a mild decline in employment.

"India's final manufacturing PMI slipped to 52.8 in August, extending its decline for a third consecutive month. The output index fell to its lowest level since August 2021, signalling that production is still expanding but at a markedly slower pace," said Pranjul Bhandari, Chief India Economist at HSBC.

New orders continued to grow, though at their weakest pace in five years. Survey respondents linked the slower expansion to difficult market conditions and softer demand for certain products.

Meanwhile, export sales continued to climb, driven by demand from key markets such as Australia, Germany, mainland China, Spain, Thailand, and the US. However, the expan-

sion rate for international orders moderated compared to July.

On the jobs front, manufacturing employment fell for the first time in two-and-a-half years, though the rate of decline was only fractional. Companies that reduced staffing levels mainly cited lower business requirements.

"Employment edged into a mild contraction in August, the first decline

after more than two years of job growth. Meanwhile, input cost pressures continued to ease, and manufacturers responded by raising selling prices more modestly," Bhandari said.

On the price front, manufacturers faced higher costs for materials, including steel, and transport, but the overall rate of inflation was moderate and the weakest for six months.

Easing cost pressures allowed companies to temper selling price increases. Consequently, output price inflation rose only marginally, hitting a 45-month low and remaining beneath its long-term average.

Going ahead, business confidence rebounded to a three-month high despite softer current conditions. Around 16 per cent of survey participants forecast higher output over the coming 12 months, while the remainder expect no change from present levels.

"Confidence rose to its highest mark since May, but remained subdued by historical standards," the survey said.

UPI transaction volumes reach all-time high of 24.51 bn in Aug

OUR CORRESPONDENT

New Delhi, September 1

Homegrown Unified Payments Interface (UPI) processed a record 24.51 billion transactions in August, primarily fuelled by Raksha Bandhan, according to data released by the National Payments Corporation of India (NPCI).

The UPI transactions in value terms were Rs 29.8 lakh crore, near a record high of Rs 29.9 lakh crore in May and July 2026.

As per the data released on Tuesday, UPI transactions in volume terms touched a record of 24.51 billion in August, much higher than 23.66 billion in the previous month.

The volume was 22.72 billion in June and 23.2 billion in May of this year.

The value of transactions was Rs 29.82 lakh crore in August, up from Rs 24.85 lakh crore in the same month a year ago, registering 20 per cent annual growth.

At the same time, UPI volume rose by 22 per cent on an annual basis to 24.51 billion in August as against 19.63 billion in the same month last year, according to NPCI data.

NPCI, an initiative of



UPI TRANSACTIONS IN VALUE TERMS WERE RS 29.8 LAKH CR, NEAR A RECORD HIGH OF RS 29.9 LAKH CR IN MAY AND JULY 2026

the Reserve Bank of India (RBI) and the Indian Banks' Association, is an umbrella organisation for operating retail payments and settlement systems in India (IBA).

It runs the UPI used for real-time payments between peers or at merchants' end while making purchases.

The volume growth in August was further bolstered by festive activity such as Raksha Bandhan, which naturally drove a surge in everyday peer-to-peer (P2P) transfers and small-ticket gifting, and consistent aggregate transaction value with an increase in volume over the past three months

underscores the expanding reach and depth of the UPI ecosystem, Cashfree Payments co-founder Reeuju Datta said.

Looking ahead, he said, the upcoming festive season presents an exciting growth frontier.

As the festive season approaches and new use cases such as credit on UPI start to mature, continued investment in resilient, intelligent infrastructure will be key to sustaining India's leadership in digital payments, Network People Services Technologies (NPST) co-founder and CEO Deepak Chand Thakur said.

As far as overseas presence is concerned, UPI now is accepted in 11 countries, with Uzbekistan being the latest entry. The other countries where UPI is accepted are Singapore, the United Arab Emirates, France, Mauritius, Nepal, Bhutan, Qatar, Sri Lanka, Cambodia, and Greece.

The UPI, launched on August 25, 2016, has transformed India's digital payments landscape, with transaction value surging from Rs 0.07 lakh crore in FY17 to around Rs 314 lakh crore in FY26, a more than 4,000-fold increase over the decade.

Briefs

Rupee rises 27 paise to 94.95/dollar

MUMBAI: The rupee gained 27 paise to close at nearly two-month high of 94.95 against the US dollar on Tuesday on robust domestic growth, controlled fiscal slippage.

At interbank forex market, rupee opened at 95.06 and traded in range of 94.79-95.10 during the day. It finally settled at 94.95, up by 27 paise from its previous close.

AY27 ITR filing touches record 7.8 cr

NEW DELHI: A record over 7.8 crore ITRs have been filed for assessment year (AY) 2026-27 till August 31, the income tax department said on Tuesday.

Last year, over 7.3 crore income tax returns (ITRs) were filed by September 16, 2025, the extended deadline for filing returns for non-audit cases for AY 2025-26.

"A record 7.8 crore+ ITRs have been filed for AY 2026-27 as on August 31, 2026," the I-T department said on X.

India's CAD widens to \$4.2 billion in June qtr amid West Asia conflict

AGENCIES

Mumbai, September 1

India's current account deficit (CAD) widened to \$4.2 billion, or 0.5 per cent of GDP, in Q1 2026-27 from \$3.4 billion, or 0.4 per cent of GDP, a year earlier, driven by a sharp rise in the merchandise trade deficit amid the West Asia conflict.

According to the Reserve Bank of India's Balance of Payments data, the merchandise trade deficit rose to \$86.1 billion in April-June 2026-27 from \$68.9 billion in the year-ago quarter.

Net services receipts increased to \$51.6 billion in Q1 2026-27 from \$47.9 billion a year earlier, with

services exports rising across major categories, including computer services, other business services and transportation services.

Net outgo under the primary income account, mainly reflecting investment income payments, declined to \$10.5 billion from \$13.3 billion in the April-June quarter of 2025-26.

Personal transfer receipts under the secondary income account, mainly representing remittances by Indians employed overseas, rose to \$42.9 billion in the first three months of 2026-27 from \$33.2 billion in the corresponding period last year.

In the financial account, foreign direct investment (FDI) recorded a net inflow of \$6.1 billion, up from \$5.2 billion in Q1 2025-26. However, foreign portfolio investment (FPI) registered a net outflow of \$9.6 billion, against a net inflow of \$1.6 billion a year earlier.

Non-resident deposits recorded a net inflow of \$2.8 billion in Q1 2026-27, compared with \$3.6 billion in Q1 2025-26. Net inflows under external commercial borrowings were also lower.

Foreign exchange reserves were depleted by \$8.1 billion on a Balance of Payments basis in Q1 2026-27, against an accretion of \$4.5 billion in Q1 2025-26.

US investments in Indian securities jump three-fold to \$390 billion in 2025

PRESS TRUST OF INDIA

Washington, September 1

The value of US investments in Indian securities has witnessed a three-fold rise from \$130 billion in 2015 to \$390 billion in 2025, according to the US Treasury Department data.

India ranked 12th in the list of 30 nations with significant exposure to US portfolio holdings. The maximum US investments were in the Cayman Islands, amounting to \$3.073 trillion, followed by the UK (2.007 trillion),

Canada (1.886 trillion), Japan (1.483 trillion) and Ireland (1.182 trillion). The preliminary data from an annual survey of US portfolio holdings of foreign securities at year-end 2025 were released on Monday.

The annual survey of US portfolio holdings was undertaken jointly by the US Department of the Treasury, the Federal Reserve Bank of New York, and the Board of Governors of the Federal Reserve System.

The survey measured the value of US holdings of

foreign securities at year-end 2025 at approximately \$19.3 trillion, with \$15.3 trillion held in foreign equities, \$3.6 trillion held in foreign long-term debt securities (original term-to-maturity in excess of one year), and \$0.4 trillion held in foreign short-term debt securities.

The previous survey, conducted as of year-end 2024, measured the value of US holdings at \$15.8 trillion, with \$12.1 trillion held in foreign equities, \$3.4 trillion held in foreign long-term debt securities,

and \$0.4 trillion held in foreign short-term debt securities. According to the survey, US portfolio holdings in Indian equity were valued at \$380 billion at the end of 2025, compared with \$373 billion a year earlier.

Holdings of Indian long-term debt securities stood at \$11 billion, up from \$10 billion. The figures measure the market value of Indian securities held by US investors. They do not include FDI in factories, infrastructure or other physical assets.

Markets close marginally lower amid higher oil prices, fresh US-Iran tensions

PRESS TRUST OF INDIA

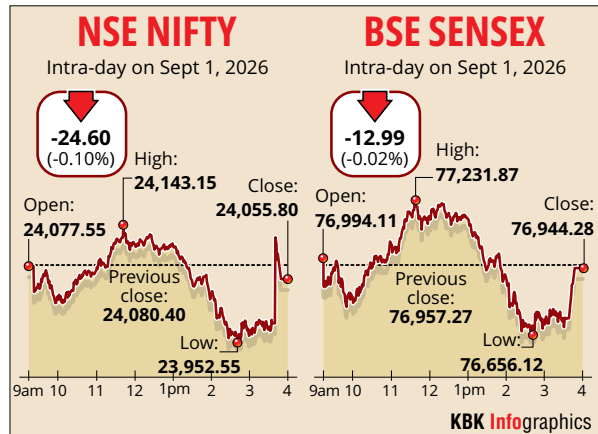
Mumbai, September 1

Benchmark stock indices Sensex and Nifty ended marginally lower on Tuesday as elevated crude oil prices and fresh US-Iran tensions weighed on investor sentiment.

After a volatile trade, the 30-share BSE Sensex ended lower by 12.99 points, or 0.02 per cent, at 76,944.28.

The 50-share NSE Nifty slipped 24.60 points, or 0.10 per cent, to end at 24,055.80 on the weekly expiry day.

Among the 30 Sensex firms, Maruti, State Bank of India, InterGlobe Aviation, Bajaj Finserv, Mahindra &



Mahindra and Axis Bank were the major laggards.

ITC, HCL Tech, Infosys and Bharti Airtel were among the winners. Brent crude, the global

oil benchmark, jumped 2.03 per cent to \$92.33 per barrel.

The BSE MidCap Select index declined 0.60 per cent and SmallCap Select

index dipped 0.40 per cent.

Among BSE sectoral indices, Auto dropped 1.41 per cent, Consumer Durables (1.25 per cent), Telecommunication (1.06 per cent), PSU Bank (0.86 per cent), Capital Goods (0.95 per cent), Financial Services (0.83 per cent) and Industrials (0.70 per cent).

IT jumped 1.24 per cent, Focused IT (1.16 per cent), Energy (0.94 per cent), FMCG (0.37 per cent), Utilities (0.22 per cent) and Housing Finance (0.22 per cent).

Foreign Institutional Investors (FIIs) offloaded equities worth Rs 7,985.88 crore on Monday, according to exchange data.

Punjab National Bank concludes its two-day inaugural AI Summit

MPOST BUREAU

New Delhi, September 1

Punjab National Bank, concluded the inaugural PNB AI Summit 2026 themed "Innovate, Integrate & Elevate" at its Corporate Office in Dwarka, New Delhi.

The two-day summit brought together policymakers, regulators, banking and technology leaders, fintechs and academia to deliberate on the next phase of AI-led transformation in financial services. Present on the occa-



sion were Dr. Debasish Prusty, Additional Secretary, Department of Financial Services (DFS); Ashok Chandra, MD&CEO, PNB; Atul Kumar Goel, Chief Executive, IBA; JBV Reddy, Head QTC, National Quan-

tum Mission, Department of Science and Technology, Government of India; Gulshan Rai, IS Advisor; and Dr. Pratik Sen, Dean, IIT Kanpur, along with senior officials from DFS, RBI and IBA.

India's power capacity likely to surpass 2,000 GW by 2047

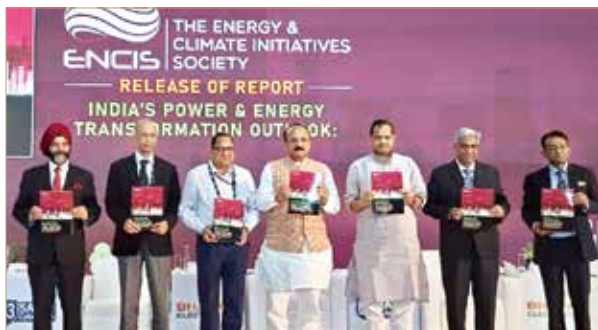
Solar power capacity is expected to rise from 119 GW to over 1,100 GW

MPOST BUREAU

New Delhi, September 1

India's installed electricity generation capacity is projected to cross 2,000 GW by 2047, driven by a major expansion in clean energy, particularly solar power, according to a report by Energy & Climate Initiatives Society (ENCIS).

The 'India's Power & Energy Transformation Outlook' report was released on Tuesday during the inaugural session of Bharat Electricity, POWER-

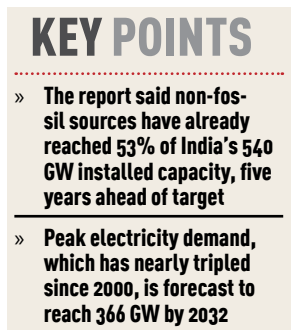


GEN India & Indian Utility Week 2026 in the capital.

Solar power capacity is expected to rise from 119 GW to over 1,100 GW, high-

lighting the infrastructure, innovation and policy support required for the Viksit Bharat vision.

The report said non-



KEY POINTS

- » The report said non-fossil sources have already reached 53% of India's 540 GW installed capacity, five years ahead of target
- » Peak electricity demand, which has nearly tripled since 2000, is forecast to reach 366 GW by 2032

fossil sources have already reached 53 per cent of India's 540 GW installed capacity, five years ahead of target. Peak electric-

ity demand, which has nearly tripled since 2000, is forecast to reach 366 GW by 2032, a 34 per cent jump, driven by data centres, e-mobility & green hydrogen.

India must nearly triple renewable energy deployment by 2030 to reach 500 GW of non-fossil capacity while maintaining reliability. Grid-scale storage will need to increase 40-fold to 200 GWh by 2030.

Smart meter deployment is on track to reach 250 million units by FY28,

enabling real-time management of 90 per cent of consumer demand and pushing average AT&C losses below 10 per cent. However, 44 GW of renewable capacity remains stuck in contract or financing limbo.

The report said coal would continue providing grid stability, with plants required to operate at 40 per cent minimum technical load and 3 per cent ramp rates by 2030. India's power sector investment requirement is pegged at \$0.5 trillion by 2030.

CORPORATE KALEIDOSCOPE



Lieutenant Governor Manoj Sinha felicitated J&K Bank, represented by MD & CEO Amitava Chatterjee, in recognition of the Bank's significant support towards the successful conduct of Shri Amarnathji Yatra 2026. The felicitation took place during the Post-Yatra Felicitation Event chaired by the Lieutenant Governor at Lok Bhawan Auditorium, Srinagar.

News at a glance

RBI appoints Suman Ray as executive director

MUMBAI: The RBI on Tuesday appointed Suman Ray as executive director. Prior to this he was serving as regional director for Maharashtra.

As a career central banker, he has experience of over three decades in the RBI, having worked in several areas, including currency management, financial inclusion, payment and settlement system, consumer education and protection, and human resources. Ray has also served as Secretary to the Western Area Local Board. He will look after Department of Deposit Insurance & Credit Guarantee Corporation and the Premises Department.

Tata arm IHCL signs 104-key Gateway hotel in Agartala

NEW DELHI: Tata Group-owned Indian Hotels Company Limited (IHCL) on Tuesday announced the signing of a 104-key Gateway-branded hotel in Agartala, Tripura. The brownfield project will expand Gateway's presence in the Northeast.

Leah Tata, Vice President and Brand Leader, Gateway Hotels & Resorts, IHCL, said the signing comes as the re-imagined brand marks its second anniversary. She said Agartala is witnessing rising hospitality demand amid increased economic activity. Gateway, which has over 60 hotels, aims to reach 100 hotels by 2030.

Happiest Minds rules out job cuts post ITC Infotech merger

NEW DELHI: Happiest Minds Technologies on Tuesday ruled out layoffs following its merger with ITC Infotech, saying the deal is driven by talent and capabilities rather than cost rationalisation.

CEO Joseph Anantharaju said ITC has stipulated continuity of the entire workforce and leadership team. He noted high utilisation at ITC Infotech at 83-84 per cent and Happiest Minds at 80 per cent.

ITC Infotech will acquire a 22.1 per cent stake in Happiest Minds for about Rs 1,330 crore before the merger. The combined entity will have over 19,000 employees and target \$1 billion turnover by FY28.

Ashok Leyland sales jump 38% to 21,038 units in Aug

NEW DELHI: Commercial vehicle maker Ashok Leyland on Tuesday reported 38 per cent year-on-year rise in total sales at 21,038 units in August 2026.

In the year-ago period, the sales stood at 15,239 units.

Domestic sales were up nearly 43 per cent at 19,438 units as against 13,622 units in August 2025, Ashok Leyland said in a statement.

Sales of medium and heavy commercial vehicles in the domestic market were at 12,408 units as against 7,991 units in the year-ago month, registering a growth of 55 per cent, it added.

LPG DEMAND SHIFTS TO PIPED NATURAL GAS

Fuel sales soar in August as erratic monsoon rains boost demand

Petrol sales by Indian Oil Corporation, Bharat Petroleum Corp Ltd & Hindustan Petroleum Corp Ltd soared 9.1% to 3.48 mn tonnes in August

OUR CORRESPONDENT
New Delhi, September 1

Petrol and diesel sales by India's three state-run fuel retailers surged in August as erratic monsoon rainfall boosted fuel demand from farmers and motorists, preliminary industry sales data showed on Tuesday.

Petrol sales by Indian Oil Corp (IOC), Bharat Petroleum Corp Ltd (BPCL) and Hindustan Petroleum Corp Ltd (HPCL) soared 9.1 per cent to 3.48 million tonnes in August, compared with 3.19 million tonnes in the corresponding period a year ago.

The surge in August follows a 9.7 per cent year-on-year growth in July.

The August volume was also 14 per cent higher than 3.05 million tonnes sold during August 2024 and 30.7 per cent above the level recorded in the same period of 2023. Month-on-month, petrol sales were up by almost a percentage to 3.45 million tonnes.

Diesel sales, a key indicator of economic activity in India, rose 10.2 per cent year-on-year to 6.27 million tonnes in August from 5.69 million tonnes a



THE AUGUST VOLUME WAS ALSO 14 PER CENT HIGHER THAN 3.05 MILLION TONNES SOLD DURING AUGUST 2024 AND 30.7 PER CENT ABOVE THE LEVEL RECORDED IN THE SAME PERIOD OF 2023

KEY POINTS

- » The surge in August follows a 9.7 per cent year-on-year growth in July. Month-on-month, petrol sales were up by almost a percentage to 3.45 million tonnes
- » Diesel sales, a key indicator of economic activity in India, rose 10.2 per cent year-on-year to 6.27 million tonnes in August from 5.69 million tonnes a year earlier
- » Jet fuel (ATF) sales rose by 5.6% to 677,100 tonnes during August — volumes that were 5.9% more than the consumption of 639,700 tonnes in August 2024 and 17.7% more than 575,400 tonnes in August 2023

consumption was up 1.3 per cent from 668,500 tonnes in July.

Liquefied petroleum gas (LPG) sales continued to fall, dropping 16.1 per cent to 2.42 million tonnes. LPG demand had fallen 17.4 per cent in July.

Industry officials said this was largely because some volumes have shifted to piped natural gas since the West Asia crisis.

LPG sales have been declining since the onset of the West Asia crisis disrupted supplies, leading to the imposition of consumption restrictions in sectors like hotels and restaurants.

The curbs were lifted in June, when sales saw an 8.6 per cent increase to 2.18 million tonnes but were lower year-on-year as some industrial and commercial users are now using piped natural gas for their needs, they said.

The August LPG consumption was 12.6 per cent lower than 2.77 million tonnes of August 2024 and 0.3 per cent lower than 2.43 million tonnes of August 2023. Month-on-month LPG sales were up 2.2 per cent to 2.37 million tonnes, the data showed.

year earlier.

August is the second month in a row of double digit growth in diesel demand. Sales were up 10.7 per cent in July.

Diesel is India's most widely used fuel, powering freight transport, agricultural machinery and irrigation. Erratic monsoon rainfall boosted irrigation demand during the peak sowing season.

The volume sold in

August was 9.7 per cent higher than in the corresponding period of 2024 and 6.3 per cent above the August 2023 consumption. On a month-on-month basis, diesel sales however fell 12 per cent from 7.13 million tonnes in July.

Fuel sales typically moderate with the onset of the monsoon, which reduces demand for running agricultural irrigation pumps as well as slows vehicular

movement. But this year, the monsoon rains arrived late, which led to farmers using diesel to run pumps to irrigate farms.

Jet fuel (ATF) sales rose by 5.6 per cent to 677,100 tonnes during August — volumes that were 5.9 per cent more than the consumption of 639,700 tonnes in August 2024 and 17.7 per cent more than 575,400 tonnes in August 2023.

Month-on-month, the

Domestic passenger vehicle sales rise 35% to 4.5 lakh units in Aug

OUR CORRESPONDENT
New Delhi, September 1

Passenger vehicle sales in India are estimated to have risen around 35 per cent to about 4.5 lakh units in August, riding on the back of robust growth posted by the likes of Maruti Suzuki India, Tata Motors Passenger Vehicles and Mahindra & Mahindra.

The automotive industry continues to benefit from the momentum generated by last year's GST rate cut, income tax benefit and repo rate cuts and is entering the festive season with optimism, Maruti Suzuki India Senior Executive Officer, Marketing & Sales, Partho Banerjee told reporters in a conference call.

"Industry is expected to be around 4.5 lakhs plus-minus maybe 2,000 to 3,000 units in August this year...Last year, the number was around 3.3 lakh units," he said.

On the growth drivers for the industry, Banerjee said, "The three tailwinds are there. One is the GST 2.0, other is the repo rate reduction, which led to the reduction in the EMI, and the third thing was the income tax exemption (on incomes up to Rs 12 lakh)."

Market leader Maruti Suzuki India reported 34.8 per cent rise in its domestic sales to 1,76,971 units last month from 1,31,278 units in the year-ago month.

Banerjee said the com-



MARUTI SUZUKI REPORTED 34.8 % RISE IN DOMESTIC SALES TO 1,76,971 UNITS LAST MONTH FROM 1,31,278 UNITS IN AUGUST 2025

pany has pending bookings to the tune of almost 1.8 lakh by the end of August with the newly launched compact SUV Brezza alone accounting for 30,000 units.

When asked about the festive season outlook, he said there is optimism and for the ongoing fiscal, the expectation is 10 per cent growth, although in the second half the high base effect will kick in.

Tata Motors Passenger Vehicles Ltd (TMPVL) also posted robust domestic passenger vehicle sales at 65,253 units last month as compared to 41,001 units in August 2025, a growth of 59 per cent.

Another homegrown major, Mahindra & Mahindra posted a 50 per cent jump in its domestic PV sales at 59,257 units in August as against 39,399 units in the same month last year.

Hyundai Motor India

HIGHLIGHTS

- » Tata Motors Passenger Vehicles Ltd (TMPVL) also posted robust domestic passenger vehicle sales at 65,253 units last month as compared to 41,001 units in August 2025, a growth of 59 per cent
- » Mahindra & Mahindra posted a 50 per cent jump in its domestic PV sales at 59,257 units in August as against 39,399 units in the same month last year

Ltd said its domestic sales were at 54,396 units, up 23.6 per cent from the year-ago month, with company Managing Director & CEO Tarun Garg stating that its August 2026 domestic sales figure was the highest-ever for any August.

Its sibling Kia India reported a 48.1 per cent growth in wholesales at 29,042 units in August 2026, as against 19,608 units in the same month last year, marking its best-ever August wholesale performance since inception.

Another automaker JSW MG Motor India reported a 14 per cent year-on-year rise in August wholesales at 7,508 units, while Nissan Motor India said its domestic wholesales recorded a 147.5 per cent YoY growth at 3,426 units in August as compared to 1,384 units in the corresponding month a year ago.

LIC launches Bima Platinum, Jeevan Raksha policies on 70th anniversary

MPOST BUREAU
New Delhi, September 1

Life Insurance Corporation (LIC) on Tuesday launched two new products, Bima Platinum & Jeevan Raksha, on the occasion of its 70th anniversary. LIC CEO & MD R Doraiswamy launched the products.

Bima Platinum is a Non-Par, Non-Linked Individual Plan offering savings and protection. It is a limited premium plan with guaranteed additions of Rs 70 per Rs 1,000 of annual premium paid during the pre-



mium-paying term. It also provides a regular income benefit equal to 10 per cent of the basic sum assured at the end of each year during the payout period.

Existing LIC policyholders & nominees/beneficiaries of deceased policyholders are eligible for rebates, while riders can enhance coverage.

Jeevan Raksha is a Non-Par, Non-Linked Pure Risk Plan providing financial protection to the insured's family in case of death during the policy term. Death benefits are guaranteed and fixed, with no bonuses or share in surplus. The minimum basic sum assured is Rs 5 lakh and maximum is Rs 24 lakh, subject to the board-approved underwriting policy. The plan offers single premium, regular premium & limited premium payment options, with special rates for women.

AGENCIES

New Delhi, September 1

The National Company Law Tribunal (NCLT) on Tuesday barred Essel Group Chairman Subhash Chandra from alienating his assets and stayed an order allowing him to settle claims arising from personal guarantees on group borrowings for about Rs 6.5 crore, against claims of roughly Rs 22,006 crore.

A five-member NCLT bench headed by President Justice Anupinder Singh Grewal said there was no clear majority view on the repayment plan. It stayed

the August 25, 2026 order of third member Nilesh Sharma and directed Chandra, the personal guarantor, not to alienate any assets directly or indirectly. The next hearing is scheduled for September 23.

Solicitor General Tushar Mehta, representing dissenting creditors including LIC Housing Finance, Canara Bank and Union Bank, sought the restraint, warning that the matter's "substratum" could otherwise be lost.

The dispute has also reached NCLAT, where dissenting lenders have challenged the repayment plan.

excluding disputed claims.

The proposed plan would allow creditors to recover about Rs 6.5 crore against roughly Rs 22,006 crore in claims. Ten lenders backed it, while dissenting creditors including HDFC Bank, LIC Housing Finance and Canara Bank opposed it.

Chandra has disputed the Rs 22,006-crore figure, saying claims against his personal guarantees stand at about Rs 3,990 crore. Lenders have also questioned his declared net worth, citing Rs 40,600 crore in 2018 and Rs 45,900 crore in 2017.

Nirmala Sitharaman meets US Treasury Secy Bessent



PRESS TRUST OF INDIA
Washington, September 1

Finance Minister Nirmala Sitharaman has met US Treasury Secretary Scott Bessent and invited him to the economic and financial partnership meeting in Delhi later this year.

Sitharaman met Bessent in Asheville, North Carolina, on the sidelines of the G20 Finance Ministers and Central Bank Governors Meeting on Monday.

"The Union Finance Minister invited Mr Bessent for the Economic & Financial Partnership to New Delhi later this year," the Finance Ministry said in a post on X.

It said Bessent appreciated India's role in G7 plus and appreciated the participation in the G7-led critical mineral dialogues to secure supply chains and share research and technology.

Sitharaman and Bessent committed to deepening this relationship between India and the US in various areas, including critical minerals.

Ahmedabad added to int'l hub & spoke network

The new operations are part of Centre's Int'l Aviation Hub Strategy

OUR CORRESPONDENT
Ahmedabad, September 1

The Ministry of Civil Aviation launched international Hub-and-Spoke flight operations from Ahmedabad on Tuesday, becoming the third airport in the country after Varanasi and Amritsar to join the government's Hub-and-Spoke system for international passengers.

The event was attended by Civil Aviation Minister Ram Mohan Naidu, Gujarat Chief Minister Bhupendra Patel, Minister of State

for Civil Aviation Murlidhar Mohol and Gujarat Deputy Chief Minister Harsh Sanghani.

International travellers would now be able to check-in their bags, immigration and custom clearance at the Ahmedabad airport as their bags would be checked through to their final destination, while at Delhi, the hub airport passengers would be able to proceed to catch their onward flight to their international destinations without going through

immigration and customs again.

The new operations seek to ease the process of international travel for passengers who used to board domestic flights to Delhi, make separate bookings, clear immigration and customs at the Delhi airport and then check in their baggage and board another domestic flight to their international destination.

Under the new operations, flight AI 1117 will carry Ahmedabad passengers to 22 destinations, mostly in

Europe, Southeast Asia and the Middle East, while the evening service AI 1121, which will depart at 8:15 pm, will link Ahmedabad with 17 destinations in North America, East Asia, Southeast Asia, Australia and Europe. Naidu said that nearly 1.6 crore passengers travel from Ahmedabad to Delhi every year to take international flights and that the new operations would ensure that Ahmedabad is well connected to international destinations which would give a boost

to the planned Ahmedabad Commonwealth Games 2030 and help bring more tourists to the city.

The new operations are part of the Centre's International Aviation Hub Strategy, unveiled recently, to establish India as a preferred aviation hub by 2030 and a leading aviation hub by 2047. The minister said that the initiative will have a positive impact on textile, pharmaceutical, diamond, gems, engineering, tourism & export industries in Gujarat.

Goyal: India world's best location for data centres

AGENCIES
New Delhi, September 1

Commerce and Industry Minister Piyush Goyal on Tuesday met data centre industry stakeholders to discuss measures to improve ease of doing business and promote investments in the sector.

Goyal said India is the world's best location for setting up data centres, adding that data centres, semiconductors, artificial intelligence and manufacturing will drive the country's growth towards a \$30 trillion economy by 2047.

"Nothing less than \$200

billion can be seen coming into the data centres industry," he said. Hyperscalers, international investors and Indian companies at the meeting highlighted the sector's significant investment potential.

Goyal also welcomed India's 7.8 per cent GDP growth in the April-June 2026 quarter despite global uncertainty and geopolitical tensions.

Responding to Congress criticism of the GDP data, he said questioning the figures was an "insult" to the 1.4 billion Indians whose hard work is driving economic growth.

Before Debts Recovery Tribunal-II, Delhi
4th Floor, Jeevan Tara Building, Parliament Street, New Delhi-110001

Notice under section 19(4) of the Recovery of Debts Due to Bank and Financial Institutions Act, 1993 read with Rule 12 & 13 of the Debts Recovery Tribunal (Procedure Rule) 1993) in the matter of
TA 111/2022 DATE: 28.07.2026

STATE BANK OF INDIA APPLICANT
VERSUS
MR RAKESH KUMAR SHARMA RESPONDENT
To,
DEFENDANT
D1. MR RAKESH KUMAR SHARMA SO SH SURESH KUMAR SHARMA
FLAT NO B-6 PLOT NO WZ-1175 SECT 7 DWARKA OPP ICICI BANK PALAM EXTN NEW DELHI
ALSO AT: C/O PINEY BOWES INDIA PVT LTD 45 OKHLA INDUSTRIAL ESTATE PHASE-3 NEW DELHI-45
D2. MR SMITA TRIPATHI WO SH RAKESH KUMAR SHARMA FLAT NO B-6 PLOT NO WZ-1175 SECT 7 DWARKA OPP ICICI BANK PALAM EXTN NEW DELHI ALSO AT: C/O ROLTAINDIA LTD 187 ROLTA TECHNOLOGY PARK UDYOG VIHAR-I GURGAON HRY
D3. MIS TULSIANI CONSTRUCTION AND DEVELOPERS LTD 37 ELGIN ROAD OPP HOTEL AJAY INTERNATIONAL CITY LINES ALLAHABAD 211001 ALSO AT: T C-34V2 CYBER TOWER 1ST FLOOR VIBHUTI KHAND GOMTI NAGAR LUCKNOW
ALSO AT: UNIT NO 408 A AND 416 K TRIDENT 2ND FLOOR 10 RANA PRATAP MARG LUCKNOW

Whereas the above named applicant (s) has / have instituted a case for recovery of Rs. 85,27,810/- (RUPEE EIGHTY FIVE LAKH TWENTY SEVEN THOUSAND EIGHT HUNDRED TEN ONLY) against you and where as it has been shown to the satisfaction of the Tribunal that it is not possible to serve you in the ordinary way therefore, this notice is given by advertisement directing you to make appearance in the Tribunal on 09.09.2026 At 11.00 A.M.
Take notice that in default of your appearance on the day before the mentioned, the case will be heard and determined in your absence.
All the matters will be taken up through Video Conferencing or Physical and for that purpose:-
(i) All the Advocates/Litigants shall download the "CaseWeb" application/software;
(ii) "Meeting ID" and Password for the date of hearing qua cases to be taken by Hon'ble Presiding officer/Registrar shall be displayed in the daily cause list itself at DRT Official Portal i.e. drt.gov.in.
(iii) In any exigency the Advocate/ Litigants can contact the concerned official at Ph. No. 23748478.
Given under my hand and seal of the Tribunal this 28th day of JULY, 2026

BY ORDER OF THE TRIBUNAL
SECTION OFFICER, DRT-II, DELHI

EAST CENTRAL RAILWAY
OPEN E-TENDER NOTICE
E-Tender Notice for supply of materials
"Participation in through" web portal of IREPS- www.ireps.gov.in Offers are invited for supply of following materials.
Tender No. : 36256184, **Brief Description :** SUPPLY OF INTER VEHICLE COUPLER FOR 3-PHASE ON-BOARD MEMU 16-CAR RAKE FORMATION IN ZONAL RAILWAYS WITH BHEL ELECTRICS DRG/ SPEC-EDML-219 REV-NIL. TABLE-1.
Quantity : 12 Sets. **Closing on :** 19.09.2026.
The Closing time for all tenders is at 14:00 HRS. Eligible Participants are required to submit their offer only through e-procurement web portal of IREPS - www.ireps.gov.in before the closing date and time. Other details regarding Consignee and detailed description of stores are available in tender documents in the tender notice on above portal. Sr. DMM/ ECR/Plt. Deen Dayal Upadhyaya PR/0840/DDU/Store/T/26-27/32

DISTRICT POLICE HEADQUARTERS SAMBA
"Look-Out Notice".

As intimated by SHO PS Bari-Brahmana vide his office letter No. 2894/5-1/PS88 Dated 25.08.2026, that on 23.08.2026 one girl namely Sapna Kumari D/o Shankar Bahadur Khadka R/o Khaptar Chana Ghau Palika, Nepal A/P Ward No. 02, Bari-Brahmana, Samba went to a nearby shop from their residence to purchase household items, but thereafter she did not return home, her search was conducted in the area but not traced out till date. On this a case FIR No 259/2026 U/S 137(2) BNS has been registered at P/S Bari Brahmana. The photograph of the said girl is required to be published/telecast in print/electronic media for his identification.

As such, a look-out notice of above mentioned girl is being published/ telecast on Print/Electronic media for information of Police Establishments so that they could be identified and any information related to her may be communicated on following contacts:-

1. PCR Samba:- 01923-246333, 9541649001
2. SSP Samba's email ID :- ssp.samba@jkpolice.gov.in
3. SHO PS Bari-Brahmana:- 8713023636

The description roll along with photograph of accused person is as under:-

Name:	Sapna Kumari
Parentage:	Shankar Bahadur Khadka
R/O :	Khaptar Chana Ghau Palika, Nepal A/P Ward No. 02, Bari-Brahmana, Samba
Age:	16 Yrs
Height:	5 Feet 2 Inch
Complexion :	Fair Skin
Face:	Oval
Body Structure:	Medium
Language:	Hindi
Attire:	Pajama T-Shirt

No. CB/Look/2026/
Dated: - 08.2026
DIP No:DIP/J-9169/26

Sd/-
Sr. Superintendent of Police,
Samba

APPENDIX IV-A
Sale Notice for sale of Immovable Property
E-Auction Sale Notice for sale of Immovable Assets under the Securitisation and Reconstruction of Financial Assets and Enforcement of Security Interest Act, 2002 read with proviso to Rule 8(6) and Rule 9(1) of the Security Interest (Enforcement) Rules, 2002.

Notice is hereby given to the public in general and in particular to the Borrower(s) and Guarantor(s) that the below described Immovable Property mortgaged to Sammaan Capital Limited (formerly known as Indiabulls Housing Finance Ltd.) [CIN : L65922DL2005PLC136029] ("Secured Creditor"), the physical possession of which has been taken by the Authorised Officer of the Secured Creditor, will be sold on "as is where is", "as is what is" and "whatever there is" basis on 21.09.2026 from 05.00 P.M. to 06.00 P.M., for recovery of Rs. 14,19,658/- (Rupees Fourteen Lakh Nineteen Thousand Six Hundred Fifty Eight only) pending towards Loan Account No. HHLNO000446685, by way of outstanding principal, arrears (including accrued late charges) and interest till 24.08.2026 with applicable future interest in terms of the Loan Agreement and other related loan document(s) w. e. f. 25.08.2026 along with legal expenses and other charges due to the Secured Creditor from LALIT MOHAN and DIPSA SHARMA @DEEPA.

The Reserve Price of the Immovable Property will be Rs. 9,33,660/- (Rupees Nine Lakh Thirty Three Thousand Six Hundred Sixty only) and the Earnest Money Deposit ("EMD") will be Rs. 93,366/- (Rupees Ninety Three Thousand Three Hundred Sixty Six only) i.e. equivalent to 10% of the Reserve Price.

DESCRIPTION OF THE IMMOVABLE PROPERTY

RESIDENTIAL FLAT BEARING NUMBER U. G. F. - 4, L. I. G., UPPER GROUND FLOOR, WITHOUT ROOF RIGHTS, LEFT HAND FRONT SIDE, HAVING TOTAL AND COVERED AREA OF 325 SQUARE FEET i. e. 30.19 SQUARE METER, SITUATED ON RESIDENTIAL PLOT NUMBER F - 9, "S. L. F. VED VIHAR", VILLAGE LONI, PARGANA AND TEHSIL LONI, DISTRICT GHAZIABAD, GHAZIABAD - 201102, UTTAR PRADESH AND THE FLAT BOUNDED AS FOLLOWS :
EAST : ROAD 9 METER WIDE,
WEST : COMMON PASSAGE AND STAIRCASE,
NORTH : FLAT NUMBER U. G. F. - 1 (M. I. G.),
SOUTH : PLOT NUMBER F - 10.

For detailed terms and conditions of sale, please refer to the link provided on the website of the Secured Creditor i.e. www.sammaancapital.com; Contact No : 0124-6910910, +91 7065451024; E-mail id : auctionhelpline@sammaancapital.com. For bidding, log on to www.auctionfocus.in.

Sd/-
AUTHORISED OFFICER
SAMMAAN CAPITAL LIMITED (Formerly known as INDIABULLS HOUSING FINANCE LTD.)

Date : 24.08.2026
Place : GHAZIABAD

JAMMU AND KASHMIR POLICE
DISTRICT POLICE HEADQUARTERS JAMMU
0191-2561578 (O), 0191-254780 (F),
email-sspjammu@jkpolice.gov.in
Hue and Cry Notice
Rule No. 712/191

SDPO City East, Jammu has intimated that accused person namely Sanjeev Kumar S/O Pila Ram R/O Dungi Gharati Rajouri is evading his arrest/wanted in case FIR No. 107/2002 U/S 279/337/304-A RPC, of P/S Bahu Fort, Jammu. Despite repeated raids/efforts the accused could not be traced/still absconded.

It is therefore requested that Hue and Cry Notice of above mentioned accused is being published for the information of Police establishments / Public in general having any clue related to the whereabouts / present location of above named accused, kindly communicate the same on the below mentioned contact / Telephone numbers.

Description Roll :-
Name : Sanjeev Kumar
S/O : Pila Ram
Address : Dungi Gharati Rajouri
Age : 60-65 Years
Contacts/Telephone Numbers:-
1.DPO, Jammu :0191-2547807, 0191-2561578
2. SSP Jammu Mail I.D : sspjammu@jkpolice.gov.in
3.PCR Jammu :0191-2605949
4.SP City South : 0191-2430002
5.SDPO City East : 01912433778
6.P/S Bahu Fort : 0191-2475133

Sd/-
Superintendent of Police
Jammu

DIP No:DIP/J-9177/26

CHHATTISGARH STATE POWER GENERATION CO. LTD.
(A Govt. of Chhattisgarh Undertaking)
No. 03-03/ TN-220/ 1513 Raipur, Dtd 31/ 08/ 2026
E-TENDER NOTICE NO. TN-220/2026-27

Online bids are invited for Supply/ work as mentioned below:-

S. No.	Tender no. /RFx no.	Description	Submission Date & time
1.	MW-276-26/27 8100053957 (With RLA)	Annual Overhaul contract for Boiler Pressure Parts of U#2 at 2x500 MW, ABVTPS, Marwa, Janjgir- Champa.	25.09.2026 Up to 15:00 Hrs
2.	HW-277-26/27 8100053964 (With RLA)	Complete O&M Work of CHP-INT (4x210 MW), HTPS, Korba (West)	28.09.2026 Up to 15:00 Hrs
3.	HW-278-26/27 8100053963 (With RLA)	Day to day Electrical Lighting Maintenance of Plant and Colony at HTPS, CSPGCL, Korba (West)	28.09.2026 Up to 15:00 Hrs
4.	CP-282-26/27 8100053979 (With RLA)	Manufacture & Supply of MS ERW Pipes of size 80 NB, 100 NB & 150 NB for HTPS Korba West	25.09.2026 Up to 15:00 Hrs

For details please visit our website <https://cspc.co.in> or e-bidding portal:- <https://ebidding.cspcl.co.in:50724/irj/portal>
samvad 48912/1

SAVE ELECTRICITY EXECUTIVE DIRECTOR(S&P:GEN) CSPGCL:RAIPUR

PROCLAMATION REQUIRING THE APPEARANCE OF ACCUSED PERSON
See Section 82 (2) (ii) Cr.P.C.

Whereas complaint has been made before me that accused persons, **Vishal@Manish Tiwari, S/o. Anil Tiwari, R/o Near Rana Chathi Maiyya Mandir Sirasapur, Samaypur, Delhi**, has committed (or is suspected to have committed) the offence in **FIR No. : 963/2022, U/s: 356/379/411/34 IPC**, registered at **P.S.: Shahbad Dairy, Delhi**, and the warrant has been returned writing upon that the said accused person, **Vishal@Manish Tiwari**, cannot be found and whereas it has been shown to my satisfaction that the said accused person, **Vishal@Manish Tiwari**, has absconded (or is concealing himself to avoid the service of the said warrant). Proclamation is hereby made that the said accused person, **Vishal@Manish Tiwari, FIR No. : 963/2022, U/s: 356/379/411/34 IPC**, registered at **P.S.: Shahbad Dairy, Delhi**, are required to appear before this court to answer the said complaint on or before **07.10.2026**.

By Order
Ms. Bharti Beniwal
Judicial Magistrate First Class-05,(North)
Room No. 114, 1st Floor, Rohini Court, Delhi

DP/12137/ON/2026
(Court Matter)

JAMMU AND KASHMIR POLICE
DISTRICT POLICE HEADQUARTERS JAMMU
0191-2561578 (O), 0191-254780 (F),
email-sspjammu@jkpolice.gov.in
Hue and Cry Notice
Rule No. 712/191

SDPO City East, Jammu has intimated that accused person namely Zulafkar Ali S/O Faqar Din R/O Salwah Tehsil Mendhar is evading his arrest/wanted in case FIR No. 90/2009 U/S 420/467/468/471/201 RPC, of P/S Bahu Fort, Jammu. Despite repeated raids/efforts the accused could not be traced/still absconded.

It is therefore requested that Hue and Cry Notice of above mentioned accused is being published for the information of Police establishments / Public in general having any clue related to the whereabouts / present location of above named accused, kindly communicate the same on the below mentioned contact / Telephone numbers.

Description Roll :-
Name : Zulafkar Ali
S/O : Faqar Din
Address : Salwah Tehsil Mendhar
Age : 45-50 Years
Contacts/Telephone Numbers:-
1.DPO, Jammu :0191-2547807, 0191-2561578
2. SSP Jammu Mail I.D : sspjammu@jkpolice.gov.in
3.PCR Jammu :0191-2605949
4.SP City South : 0191-2430002
5.SDPO City East : 01912433778
6.P/S Bahu Fort : 0191-2475133

Sd/-
Superintendent of Police
Jammu

DIP No:DIP/J-9180/26

NORTH CENTRAL RAILWAY
No.- Jhansi/W/T/Tender General/194 Date: 28.08.2026
E-Tendering Tender Notice

Divisional Railway Manager (Works) North Central Railway, Jhansi for and behalf of President of India invites sealed "Open Tender" through on Line (E-Tendering) for the following work.

E-Tender No.: JHS-ENGG-C-2026-194 **Approx Cost:** 12700000.00

Description of work: Zone No. 6 & 7- Annual Sectional Contract for repairs and maintenance work and supply of material under ADEN/CNB from PRN(Incl.) to JUHI (Excl.) & AIT to Konch (Incl.) for the year 2026-27

Earnest Money: 254000.00 **Date of closing Tender:** 18/09/2026 at 15:00 hrs.

Date of Completion/period from issue acceptance letter: 12 Months.

Tender online can be submitted up to 15:00 hrs. on 18.09.2026. For full details and submission of bid please see the Indian Railways website www.ireps.gov.in

North central railways @ www.ncr.indianrailways.gov.in @ CPRONCR 2001/26(K)

NORTH CENTRAL RAILWAY
E-Procurement Tender Notice No. 26/41 Dated: 28.08.2026
E-Procurement Tender Notice

On behalf of the President of India, The Principal Chief Materials Manager, North Central Railway, Prayagraj (An ISO 9001:2015 certified unit) invites the following E-Procurement Tenders:

S. N.	Tender No.	Short Description	Qty.	Tender Opening Date
1	30262378	Kit for Brake Gear Bushes for BMBC coaches	1856 Set	15.09.2026
2	30261684	HANGER FOR BOLSTER SPRING SUSPENSION	7298 Nos.	18.09.2026
3	90262034	DENSIFIED RESIN IMPREGNATED COMPRESSED PLYWOOD	7392 Nos.	28.09.2026
4	38261884	PLATED HEX NUT WITH TORX SCREW FOR AXIL	91165 Nos.	05.10.2026
5	30262713	AXLE BOX PIVOT BUSH	5396 Nos.	13.10.2026
6	38262619	KNUCKLE PIVOT PIN WITH WASHER	17890 Nos.	15.10.2026
7	30261672	DOUBLE ACTING HYDRAULIC SHOCK ABSORBER	1924 Nos.	20.10.2026
8	30261014	POH KIT FOR C3W DISTRIBUTOR VALVE	1537 Set.	29.10.2026
9	38261324	Slack adjuster type IRSA-600 complete	661 Nos.	05.11.2026
10	30262884	Flex Ball Cable (L-2197 MM)	92 Nos.	17.11.2026
11	38261870A	AIR HOSE COUPLING SUPPORT	41177 Nos.	14.10.2026
12	8226RGCC InjAnthie mophilica	Inj. Anthemophilic Factor VIII 500 IU	1110 Nos.	18.09.2026
13	60265003	Inverter Based MIG/MAG	22 Nos.	21.10.2026
14	60265028	Hydraulic Re-railing Equipment with all accessories	1 Set.	15.10.2026
15	60255034A	Coil Spring Scragging Machine	1 Nos.	12.10.2026
16	60255036	Rail cum Road shunter (Diesel operated)	1 Nos.	23.10.2026
17	6426RC01	RATE CONTRACT FOR SUPPLY OF PLASSAR MAKE SPARES FOR TRACK MACHINES FOR THE YEARS 2026-27 AND 2027-28.	1 Set.	21.09.2026
18	80261067	LIGHT DIESEL OIL (LDO)	159863 Ltrs	16.09.2026
19	20263449	Set of Damper (Shock Absorbers)	74 Set.	30.09.2026

Note: The complete information of above tenders can be seen and downloaded from IREPS website i.e. <http://www.ireps.gov.in>. For any change/corrigendum in tender, please visit the website regularly. No separate corrigendum/change will be published in news paper. 2003/26 (MG)

North central railways @ CPRONCR @ www.ncr.indianrailways.gov.in

PROCLAMATION REQUIRING THE APPEARANCE OF ACCUSED PERSON
See Section 82Cr.P.C.

Whereas complaint has been made before me that accused **Nitish Kumar, S/o: Ranjeet Mahto, R/o: D-20, Safeda Jhugoi, Shamshan Ghat, Pusta 9-Block, Geeta Colony, Delhi** has committed (or is suspected to have committed) the offence in case **FIR No. 559/2023, U/s 380/411 IPC, P.S.: Geeta Colony, Delhi** and it has been returned to a warrant of arrest thereupon issued that the said accused **Nitish Kumar** cannot be found and whereas it has been shown to my satisfaction that the said accused **Nitish Kumar** has absconded (or is concealing himself to avoid the service of the said warrant).

Proclamation is hereby made that the said **Nitish Kumar** accused of offence in case **FIR No. 559/2023, U/s 380/411 IPC, P.S.: Geeta Colony, Delhi** and is required to appear before this Court to answer the said complaint on or before **15.10.2026**.

By Order
Ms. Prema Rai
Judicial Magistrate First Class-02 (East)
Room No. 15, Karkardooma Court, Delhi

DP/12327/SHD/2026
(Court Matter)

PROCLAMATION REQUIRING THE APPEARANCE OF ACCUSED PERSON
See Section 82 Cr.P.C / 84 Bharatiya Nagarik Suraksha Sanhita, 2023

Whereas complaint has been made before me that the accused **Dheeraj, S/o. Amar Chaudhary, R/o.: H.No. 6, 3rd Floor, Sarai Peepal Thala, Adesh Nagar, Delhi** has committed (or is suspected to have committed) the offence in a case vide **FIR No.797/2022 U/s 379/411/34 IPC** registered at **P.S Alipur, Outer North District, Delhi** and it has been returned on a warrant of arrest thereupon issued stating that the said accused **Dheeraj** could not be found and whereas it has been shown to my satisfaction that accused **Dheeraj** is absconded (or is concealing himself to avoid the service of the said warrant).

Proclamation is hereby made that the said **Dheeraj**, accused of **FIR No.797/2022 U/s 379/411/34 IPC, P.S Alipur, Outer North District, Delhi** is required to appear before the court to answer the said complaint on or before **06.10.2026**.

By Order, Ms. Priyanka Rajpoot,
Chief Judicial Magistrate, North
Room No.115, First Floor,
Rohini Courts, Delhi.

DP/12281/ON/2026
(Court Matter)

Arcil
Asset Reconstruction Company (India) Ltd. (Arcil)
Acting in its capacity as Trustee of various Arcil Trusts
Arcil office : The Ruby, 10th floor, 29, Senapati Bapat Marg, Dadar (West), Mumbai - 400 028.
Website : <https://auction.arcil.co.in>; CIN - U65999MH2002PLC134884

PUBLIC NOTICE FOR SALE THROUGH ONLINE E-AUCTION IN EXERCISE OF THE POWERS UNDER THE SECURITISATION AND RECONSTRUCTION OF FINANCIAL ASSETS AND ENFORCEMENT OF SECURITY INTEREST ACT, 2002 (SARFAESI ACT) READ WITH RULES 6, 8 & 9 OF SECURITY INTEREST (ENFORCEMENT) RULES, 2002

Notice is hereby given to the public in general and to the Borrower (s) / Guarantor (s) / Mortgagor (s), in particular, that the below described immovable property/ies mortgaged / charged to the Asset Reconstruction Company (India) Limited, acting in its capacity as Trustee of various Arcil Trusts ("ARCIL") (pursuant to the assignment of financial asset vide registered Assignment Agreements), will be sold on "As is where is", "As is what is", "Whatever there is" and "Without recourse basis" by way of online e - auction, for recovery of outstanding dues of together with further interest, charges and costs etc., as detailed below in terms of the provisions of the Securitization and Reconstruction of Financial Assets and Enforcement of Security Interest Act, 2002 ("Act") read with Rules 6, 8 and 9 of the Security Interest (Enforcement) Rules, 2002 ("Rules").

Name of the Borrower / Co - Borrower/s / Guarantor/s / Mortgagor/s	LAN No. & Selling Bank	Trust Name	Outstanding Amount as per SARFAESI Notice Dated 16.08.2023 Respectively	Possession Type and Date	Date of Inspection	Type of Property and Area	Earnest Money Deposit (EMD)	Reserve Price	Date & Time of E-Auction
Borrower : 1. AMAN SHARMA 2. AKHILESH KUMAR 3. AKASH SHARMA	Loan Account No. HHLVAS00262534 Sammaan Capital Limited ("SCL") (formerly known as Indiabulls Housing Finance Limited)	Arcil - Trust - 2025-007	Rs. 11,48,476.52/- (Rupees Eleven Lakh Forty Eight Thousand Four Hundred Seventy Six and Paise Fifty Two only) as on 14.08.2023 + further Interest thereon + Legal Expenses	Physical possession on 04.04.2025	Will be arranged on request	Free Hold - 556 Sq. Ft. (built - up area)	Rs. 1,34,000/- (Rupees One Lakh Thirty Four Thousand only)	Rs. 13,40,000/- (Rupees Thirteen Lakh Forty Thousand only)	On 30.09.2026 at 05:15 P.M.

Description of the Secured Asset being auctioned :
FLAT NO. G - 2, ON GROUND FLOOR (MIG), ADMEASURING 556 SQ. FT. (BUILT - UP AREA), WITHOUT ROOF RIGHT, REAR SIDE, SITUATED ON PLOT NO. A - 49, DLF DILSHAD EXTN. - II, GHAZIABAD - 201005, UTTAR PRADESH.
BOUNDED BY : EAST : COMMON PASSAGE / FLAT NO. G - 1; WEST : PROPERTY OF OTHERS; NORTH : PLOT NO. A - 48; SOUTH : PLOT NO. A - 50.

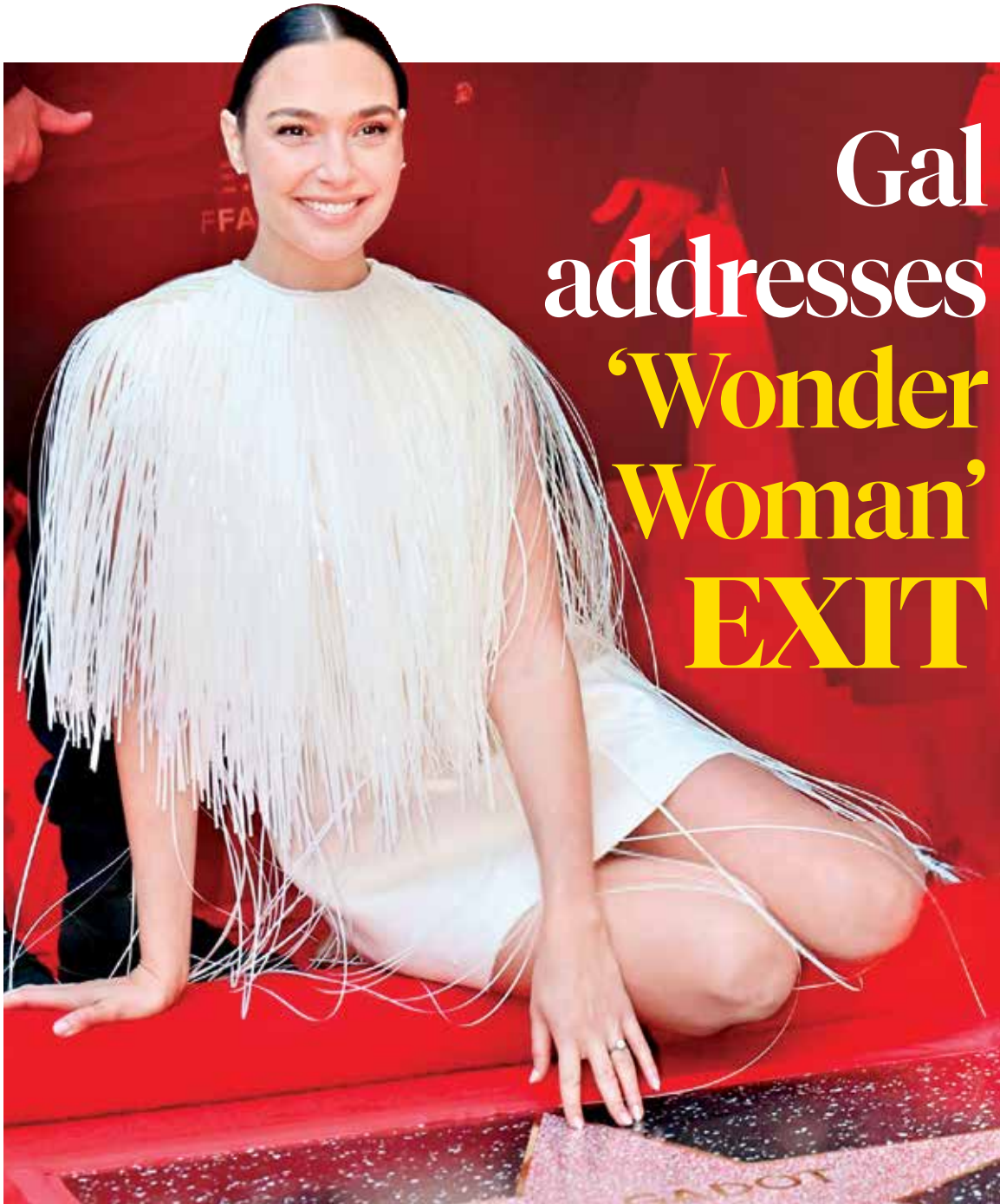
Pending Litigations known to ARCIL	Nil	Encumbrances / Dues known to ARCIL	Nil
Last Date for submission of Bid	Same day 2 hours before Auction	Bid Increment amount :	As mentioned in the BID document
Demand Draft to be made in name of :	ARCIL - TRUST - 2025-007	Payable at par	
RTGS details	ARCIL - TRUST - 2025-007, Trust Account No. - 57500001510599, HDFC Bank Limited, Branch : Kamla Mills, Mumbai, IFSC Code : HDFC0000542.		
Name of Contact person & number	Sanjeev Godara - 0124-6910910; +91 70654 51024 (auctionhelpline@sammaancapital.com).		

Terms and Conditions :

1. The Auction Sale is being conducted through e-auction through the website <https://auction.arcil.co.in> and as per the Terms and Conditions of the Bid Document, and as per the procedure set out therein.
2. The Authorised Officer ("AO") /ARCIL shall not be held responsible for internet connectivity, network problems, system crash down, power failure etc.
3. At any stage of the auction, the "AO" may accept / reject / modify / cancel the bid / offer or post - pone the Auction without assigning any reason thereof and without any prior notice.
4. The successful purchaser / bidder shall bear any statutory dues, taxes, fees payable, applicable GST on the purchase consideration, stamp duty, registration fees, etc. that is required to be paid in order to get the secured asset conveyed / delivered in his / her / its favour as per the applicable law.
5. The intending bidders should make their own independent enquiries / due diligence regarding encumbrances, title of secured asset and claims / rights / dues affecting the secured assets, including statutory dues, etc., prior to submitting their bid. The auction advertisement does not constitute and will not constitute any commitment or any representation of ARCIL. The Authorized Officer of ARCIL shall not be responsible in any way for any third - party claims / rights / dues.
6. The particulars specified in the auction notice published in the newspaper have been stated to the best of the information of the undersigned; however undersigned shall not be responsible / liable for any error, misstatement or omission.
7. The Borrower / Guarantors / Mortgagors, who are liable for the said outstanding dues, shall treat this Sale Notice as a notice under Rules 8 and 9 of the Security Interest (Enforcement) Rules, about the holding of the above mentioned auction sale.
8. In the event, the auction scheduled hereinabove fails for any reason whatsoever, ARCIL has the right to sell the secured asset by any other methods under the provisions of Rule 8(5) of the Rules and the Act.

Place : GHAZIABAD
Date : 20.08.2026

Sd/-
Authorized Officer
Asset Reconstruction Company (India) Ltd. (Trustee of Arcil-Trust-2025-007)



Gadot called DC's treatment of co-star Henry Cavill 'not elegant'

Gal Gadot finally opened up about the end of her run as Wonder Woman, saying she wasn't surprised she was ultimately no longer part of the DC Universe (DCU), despite the makers initially expressing interest in continuing to work with her. She also criticised the production company for the way it cut ties with actor Henry Cavill, who played Superman in the DC Extended Universe (DCEU) and director Patty Jenkins.

In a recent interview, the actress said she wouldn't return as Wonder Woman, even if offered the role. "For me to go to do another Wonder Woman, I am not sure I would at this point in my life with four children and different schools and all of that. To check out from all of them for such a long period of time, it doesn't work for my life anymore at this point," the actor reportedly said during an appearance on Josh Horowitz's 'Happy Sad



Confused' podcast.

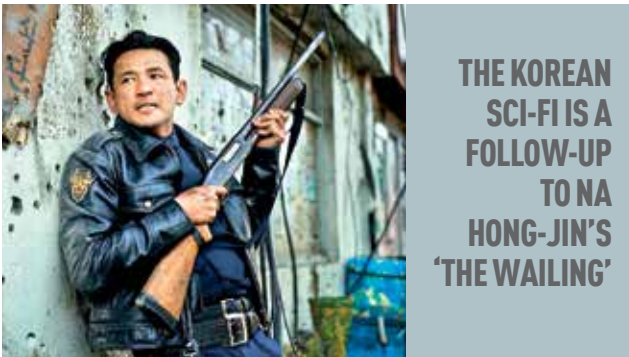
Reacting to DC Studios' decision not to bring her back, Gadot said, "I saw the way everybody else was handled. The Henry Cavill situation was not handled elegantly, to say the least. Patty Jenkins was not handled elegantly. We're all adults and we're all good."

She, however, expressed her gratitude for having had the

opportunity to play the character and extended her best wishes to whoever reprises the role. "I am so grateful I got the opportunity to wear these boots and have the character be so celebrated. I can only wish whoever is next comes pure to this journey. This character means so much to so many of us. It was never mine. I was always just a vessel. This is Hollywood."

AGENCIES

'Hope' to release in India on September 25



Korean filmmaker Na Hong-jin's 'Hope', his follow-up to 2016 horror hit 'The Wailing', is all set to release in Indian theatres on September 25.

The movie, which had its world premiere at the Cannes Film Festival, features top Korean stars like Hwang Jung-min, Zo In-sung, Hyeon, alongside Hollywood actors Taylor Russell, Cameron Britton, Alicia Vikander and Michael Fassbender. It will be released in India in English, Hindi, Tamil, Telugu, and Korean.

In 'Hope', a village police chief and his rookie deputy must defend the community from a mysterious creature after wildfires sever all com-

munications. At the same time, a local hunting party finds itself being hunted deep in the mountains.

The film marks Na's return to filmmaking after a gap of a decade. It was also his fourth consecutive film to be invited to Cannes following 'Chaser', 'The Yellow Sea' and 'The Wailing'.

With 'Hope', Na said, he wanted to create a film that begins with the primal fear of encountering an unknown creature and gradually expands into a story about survival, human instinct and the consequences of fear.

"We wanted the world of the film to feel both immediate and unpredictable," he added.

PTI

Shalini addresses AI-generated video

Pandey requested fans and followers not to engage with such content

Shalini Pandey reacted to her fake AI video circulating on social media and requested fans and followers not to engage with such content and rather report it.

The actress said it is 'deeply disturbing' to witness the misuse of the technology targeting different individuals, especially women. She shared a note on her 'Instagram' handle on Monday as she addressed the circulation of the video.

"I want to address a fake, AI-generated video of me which is currently being circulated online. The video is completely fabricated and does not depict me. It's deeply disturbing... I

strongly condemn this kind of abuse and think such misuse of technology should never be normalised," she said.

She added, "If you come across this video, please do not share, forward, download or engage. Instead, report it immediately."

PTI



BABITA SINGH REPORTING

Beyond murder & mystery

OUR CORRESPONDENT
New Delhi, September 1

Since its premiere, 'Babita Singh Reporting' has received a strong response, with audiences and critics praising its layered narrative, nuanced storytelling and standout performances. At the centre of the film is an investigation that gradually expands beyond the murder, weaving together mystery, emotion and the complexities of Baby's personal and professional life. Nimisha Sajayan's portrayal of Baby has emerged as one of the film's key highlights, bringing depth and vulnerability to a woman navigating family expectations, self-doubt and her pursuit of the truth. With its grounded world, authentic characters and delicate balance of suspense and emotion, the film explores identity, relationships and



self-discovery without losing sight of the investigation at its core.

Executive Producer Sudip Sharma, known for acclaimed cop dramas such as 'Paatal Lok' and 'Kohraa', shared what sets 'Babita Singh Reporting' apart from the cop stories he has been associated with so far: "It was a very well-written script, which is rare to find. The script was like gold,

something so good coming from Amita Vyas. But what really set this cop story apart from the other cop stories I've done was that, while it is about a female cop, more importantly, it is about her as a person and as an individual. Babita has so many roles in her life - she is a wife, a daughter-in-law and she has always put those roles ahead of her own professional ambitions and goals,

choosing to think about herself later. What I found beautiful about her journey was watching her take that first step towards listening to herself and making decisions based on what she believes is right, irrespective of what others think. These may seem like small steps, but they are incredibly important because, with each one, she moves closer to understanding herself. That balance between wanting to find the truth and, in the process, finding yourself was what I found so powerful and beautiful about the story."

Directed by Ambiecka Pandit and written by Amita Vyas, 'Babita Singh Reporting' follows suspended police officer Babita aka Baby, whose search for answers after the murder of her childhood friend becomes an unexpected journey of self-discovery.

FILMS BY RIMA DAS, ANUPARNA ROY & LEO THADDEUS SELECTED FOR BIFF 2026

Das, known for indie gems such as 'Village Rockstars', 'Bulbul Can Singh' and 'Tora's Husband', is returning to the festival with 'Not a Hero'

Six Indian films, including Rima Das' 'Not a Hero', Anuparna Roy's 'Lovers in the Blue Night', Leo Thaddeus' 'The Soul Whisperer' and Vishwendra Singh's 'Khorriya', have been selected for the prestigious Busan International Film Festival.

'Birds on Ice' by Sahil Shah and Sandeep Kumar Paul's 'About an Intimate Matter' are also part of the selection. These films will have their world premiere in the 'A Window on Asian Cinema' category, BIFF's prominent non-competitive section that showcases new and notable works by filmmakers from across Asia. The 31st Busan International Film Festival will be held from October 6 to 15, 2026, at the Busan Cinema Centre in Busan, South Korea.

Das, known for indie gems such as 'Village Rockstars', 'Bulbul Can Singh' and 'Tora's Husband', is returning to the festival with 'Not a Hero' after her 'Village Rockstars 2' premiered at the festival and won the Kim Jiseok Award. 'Not a Hero' is a coming-of-age drama about a young boy who is sent from the city to live in a village.

Roy, who became the first Indian filmmaker to win the best director award at the Ven-



ice Film Festival for her debut feature 'Songs of Forgotten Trees' in the 'Orizzonti Competition', is part of the segment with her new film 'Lovers In the

Blue Night'. The new movie is also selected for Venice. She is also part of the shorts jury at Busan.

"Having an Asian Premiere

ROY IS PART OF THE SEGMENT WITH HER NEW FILM 'LOVERS IN THE BLUE NIGHT'

in Busan feels incredibly special to me. To see the film find its way to this wonderful audience and to return to Busan as a jury member is an honour I receive with a very full heart. I feel deeply grateful for the trust, the opportunity and for being surrounded by so many beautiful stories and voices from across Asia. Cin-

ema has a way of bringing us together and I feel very lucky to be a small part of that journey," Roy shared in a statement with PTI.

Thaddeus' Malayalam Feature 'Chevittorma' ('The Soul Whisperer'), starring Dileesh Pothan and Pauly Valsan, will also have its world premiere in 'A Window on Asian Cinema'.

"What drew me to the film was Leo's sensitivity in approaching the story and his willingness to let silence, stillness and performance speak for themselves," Pothan, who co-produced Fahadh Fasil's 'Kumbalangi Nights' and directed 'Joji', shared.

Thaddeus, who has written and directed the movie, said making the film was an attempt to step away from the pace and conventions of mainstream cinema and explore a more intimate, patient form of storytelling. He said the Busan premiere of the movie gives a film from Kerala an opportunity to travel beyond its geographical and cultural boundaries and connect with audiences in another part of Asia. The film is produced by Stephen Zacharias, Aditya Grover and Harsh Agarwal.

Singh's 'Khorriya' is a Nepali and Hindi language drama that

has been produced by Niharika Singh, Faraz Khan and Prayas Deepti. Filmmaker Ashim Ahluwalia serves as executive producer on the movie, about two Nepali half-brothers running a poultry farm on the outskirts of Delhi NCR during a sudden bird flu outbreak.

"'Khorriya' began with my interest in people who have been deprived of a sense of home - people who leave everything behind and arrive in an unfamiliar city in search of a more dignified life," said Vishwendra Singh.

Ahluwalia, known for 'Miss Lovely', said 'Khorriya' feels like the emergence of a very distinct filmmaking voice.

Busan has also selected Indian film 'Selvi' by Sailesh Rathnakumar in the 'Vision Asia' category alongside 'Birds in the Dark', by Shashank Walia. Actor Anjali Patil has produced and stars in 'Selvi' while 'Birds in the Dark' is produced by Hansal Mehta and co-produced by Sahil Saigal, Reema Kaur, Mauli Singh and Gagan Deep Kaur. Mauli also stars in the movie, titled 'Hanere de Panchi' in Punjabi.

'Salt Electric' by Promita Dhar is part of the 'Wide Angle: Asian Short Film Competition'.

PTI